



Electronic Protest  
Docketing System  
(EPDS) U.S.  
Government  
Accountability Office  
(GAO) Supervisor and  
Attorney Manual

October 2021

## Table of Contents

|                                                               |           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Table of Contents .....</b>                                | <b>i</b>  |
| <b>1.0 Introduction .....</b>                                 | <b>1</b>  |
| 1.1 Scope.....                                                | 1         |
| <b>2.0 Getting Started .....</b>                              | <b>2</b>  |
| 2.1 Web Browser .....                                         | 3         |
| 2.2 Administrator Access .....                                | 3         |
| 2.3 Initial Log In .....                                      | 3         |
| 2.4 On-going Log In .....                                     | 6         |
| <b>3.0 Application Introduction .....</b>                     | <b>7</b>  |
| <b>4.0 Dashboard.....</b>                                     | <b>9</b>  |
| 4.1 Modify Dashboard.....                                     | 10        |
| <b>5.0 Case Information .....</b>                             | <b>12</b> |
| 5.1 View an Assigned Case/Case Docket Sheet .....             | 12        |
| 5.2 Case Docket Sheet.....                                    | 12        |
| 5.3 Alerts.....                                               | 14        |
| 5.4 Opening Attachments .....                                 | 15        |
| 5.5 Adding a Minute Entry.....                                | 15        |
| 5.6 Changing a Filing Protected Status.....                   | 16        |
| 5.7 Case Docket Sheet Actions .....                           | 17        |
| 5.7.1 <i>Submit New Documents</i> .....                       | 18        |
| 5.7.2 <i>Parties</i> .....                                    | 21        |
| 5.7.3 <i>Email Preferences</i> .....                          | 25        |
| 5.7.4 <i>Advanced Search</i> .....                            | 28        |
| <b>6.0 Protected Material .....</b>                           | <b>29</b> |
| 6.1 Protecting New Cases and Subsequent Filings .....         | 29        |
| 6.2 Redacted Versions of GAO Decisions .....                  | 31        |
| 6.2.1 <i>Issuing a Proposed Redacted Version</i> .....        | 32        |
| 6.2.2 <i>Issuing a Public Decision</i> .....                  | 33        |
| 6.3 Protective Order.....                                     | 35        |
| 6.3.1 <i>Admission to a Protective Order</i> .....            | 36        |
| 6.3.2 <i>Revocation of Access to a Protective Order</i> ..... | 41        |
| <b>4. Closing/Completing Cases .....</b>                      | <b>44</b> |
| a. Closing Cases .....                                        | 44        |
| a. Completing Cases.....                                      | 46        |
| i. <i>Mark as Complete</i> .....                              | 46        |
| i. <i>Case Completion Workflow</i> .....                      | 48        |

---

|           |                                       |           |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|-----------|
| b.        | Verifying Cases .....                 | 49        |
| a.        | Updating the DM# .....                | 50        |
| <b>2.</b> | <b>Manage Profile .....</b>           | <b>52</b> |
| <b>2.</b> | <b>Manage Password .....</b>          | <b>54</b> |
| a.        | Change Password .....                 | 54        |
| b.        | Reset Password .....                  | 56        |
| <b>2.</b> | <b>Change Security Questions.....</b> | <b>59</b> |
| <b>3.</b> | <b>System Unavailability.....</b>     | <b>61</b> |
|           | <b>List of Acronyms .....</b>         | <b>62</b> |

## 1.0 Introduction

For more than 80 years, GAO has provided an objective, independent, and impartial forum for the resolution of disputes concerning the awards of federal contracts. The Consolidated Appropriations Act of 2014,<sup>1</sup> directed GAO to develop an electronic protest docketing system and authorized GAO to collect and use fees to offset the costs of the system.

GAO's Electronic Protest Docketing System (EPDS) is an automated case management system that allows parties to a case to file documents over the Internet and provides GAO with the ability to make electronic documents available to the parties over the Internet. Use of EPDS is mandatory, except as set forth in the EPDS instructions available at <http://gao.gov/legal/>. For example, classified material must never be filed through EPDS.

EPDS is easy to use; a filer creates a document using conventional word processing software and converts it to a Portable Document Format (PDF). After logging into EPDS, the filer enters basic information relating to the document, attaches the PDF file and submits it to GAO. A notice verifying receipt of the filing is automatically generated and emailed to the other case participants.

This guide is intended for **GAO supervisors and attorneys**.

## 1.1 Scope

The scope of this manual is to provide instructions on utilizing the GAO EPDS. This manual does not provide information on the protest process. For information on the protest process, please visit the GAO website at <http://www.gao.gov/legal/>. If you need assistance in utilizing EPDS, please contact GAO at 202-512-5436 or <mailto:protests@gao.gov>.

---

<sup>1</sup> Pub. L. No. 113-76, div. I, title I, § 1501, 128 Stat. 5, 433-34 (Jan. 17, 2014).

## 2.0 Getting Started

The GAO EPDS site is at: [https://epdstest.edc.usda.gov/EPDS\\_Web/login](https://epdstest.edc.usda.gov/EPDS_Web/login).

By utilizing the site, users agree to following:

- You are accessing a U.S. Government information system, which includes (1) this computer, (2) this computer network, (3) all computers connected to this network, and (4) all devices and storage media attached to this network or to a computer on this network. This information system is provided for U.S. Government-authorized use only.
- Unauthorized or improper use of this system may result in disciplinary action, as well as civil and criminal penalties.
- Subject to the provisions in 4 C.F.R. §§ 21.1(g) and 21.4 and 4 C.F.R. part 81, which include procedures for protecting proprietary, confidential, and other procurement sensitive information, by using this information system, you understand and consent to the following:
  - You have no reasonable expectation of privacy regarding any communications or data transiting or stored on this information system. At any time, the government may for any lawful government purpose monitor, intercept, search and seize any communication or data transiting or stored on this information system. Accordingly, pursuant to GAO's Electronic Protest Docketing System Instructions, the following personal identifiers should be excluded, or redacted when inclusion is necessary, from all filings, unless otherwise directed by GAO:
    1. Social Security Numbers. If an individual's Social Security number must be included in a filing, only the last four digits of the numbers should be used.
    2. Dates of Birth. If an individual's date of birth must be included in a filing, only the year should be used.
    3. Financial Account Numbers. If a financial account number is relevant to a filing, only the last four digits of the number should be used.
  - Any communications or data transiting or stored on this information system may be disclosed or used for any lawful government purpose.
  - Your consent is final and irrevocable. You may not rely on any statements or informal policies purporting to provide you with any expectation of privacy regarding communications on this system, whether oral or written, by your supervisor or any other official, except GAO's Chief Information Officer.

## 2.1 Web Browser

Use one of these supported web browsers:

- Google Chrome
- Firefox
- Safari
- Microsoft Edge

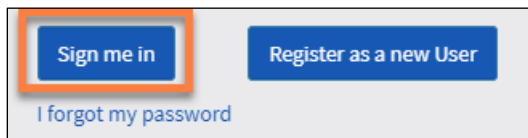
## 2.2 Administrator Access

The **system administrator (sys admin)** grants users access as GAO supervisors as determined by GAO. GAO will provide the sys admin with the names of supervisors.

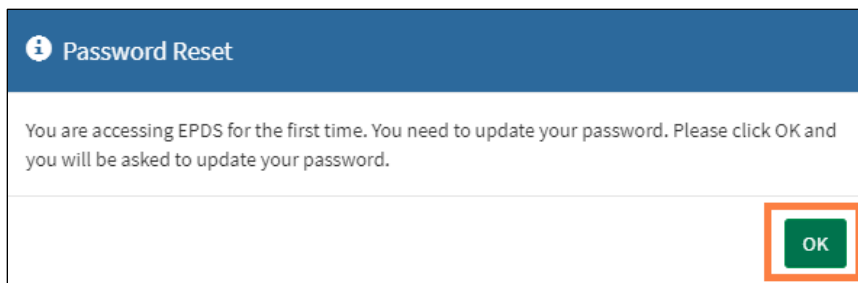
## 2.3 Initial Log In

To log in to the system:

1. You will be issued a temporary password when your EPDS account is initially created. Upon logging into the system the first time, you will be prompted to create a password and answer security questions. For subsequent log in activity, enter your EPDS-registered email address and newly created password in the appropriate fields. Select **Sign me in**.

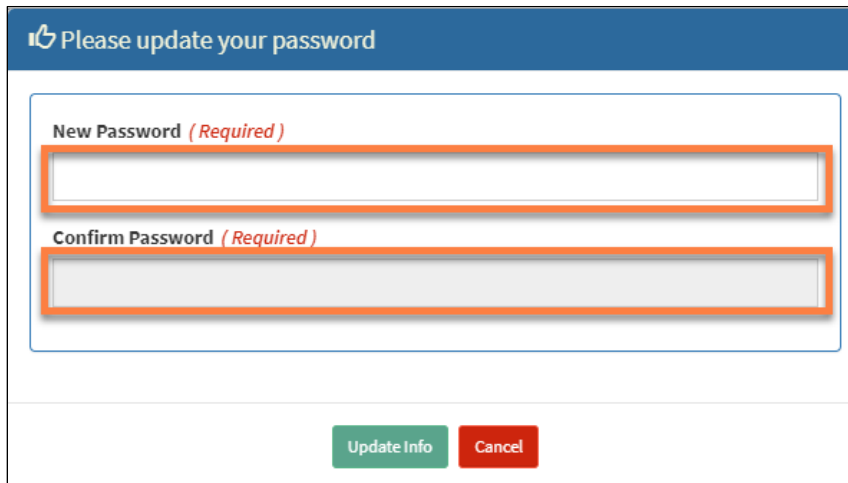


2. Upon your **initial log in**, the system will prompt you to update your password. Select **OK** to proceed.



3. Update your password by entering a **New Password** and confirming it.

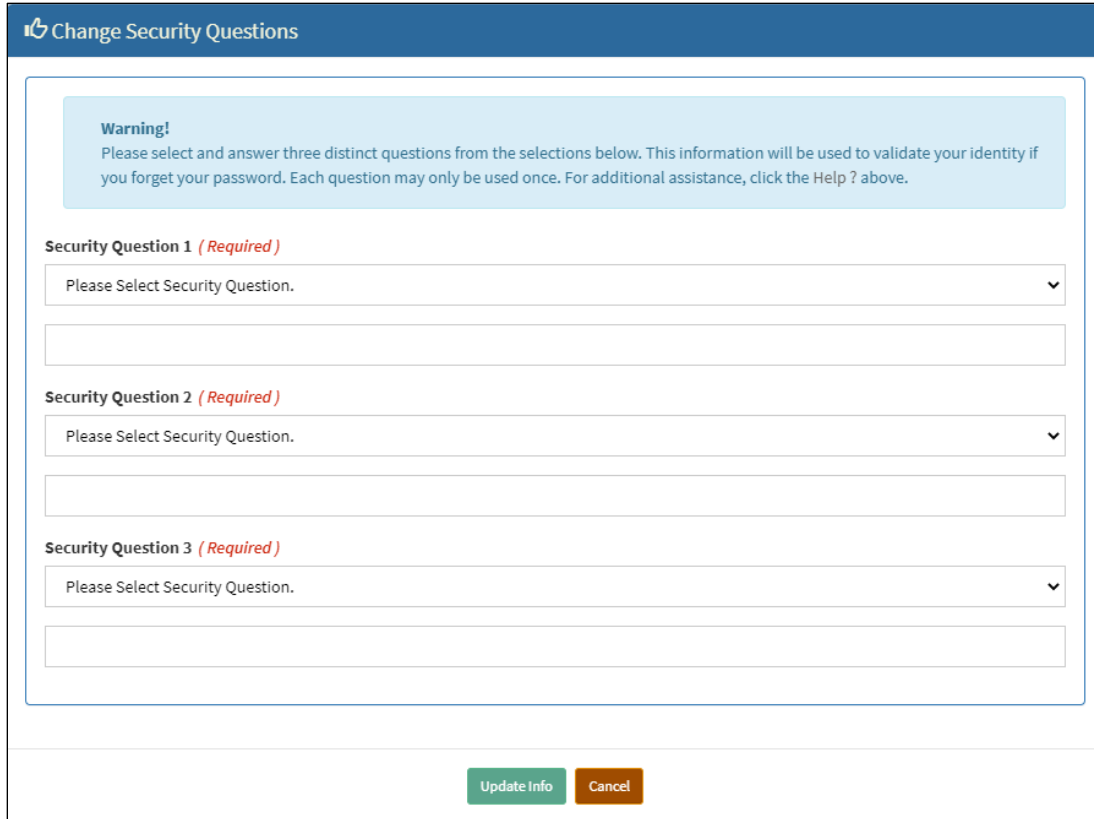
3. Update your password by entering a **New Password** and confirming it.



The screenshot shows a web form titled "Please update your password" with a blue header bar. Below the header, there are two text input fields. The first field is labeled "New Password (Required)" and the second field is labeled "Confirm Password (Required)". Both fields are outlined with a thick orange border. At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: a green "Update Info" button and a red "Cancel" button.

Passwords must be between 12 and 24 characters in length, and contain **one character from each of the following four categories**:

- English uppercase characters (A to Z)
  - English lowercase characters (a to z)
  - Base 10 digits (0 to 9)
  - Special characters (For example, #, \$, and ^)
4. The **Security Question** section will be used for password reset, should you forget your password. Select and answer three distinct security questions from the dropdown selections. Select **Update Info**.



**Change Security Questions**

**Warning!**  
Please select and answer three distinct questions from the selections below. This information will be used to validate your identity if you forget your password. Each question may only be used once. For additional assistance, click the Help ? above.

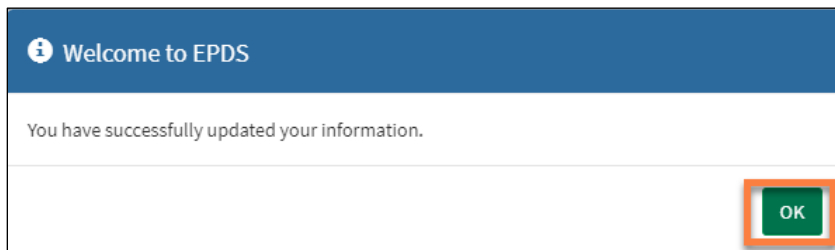
**Security Question 1 (Required)**  
Please Select Security Question. ▼

**Security Question 2 (Required)**  
Please Select Security Question. ▼

**Security Question 3 (Required)**  
Please Select Security Question. ▼

[Update Info](#) [Cancel](#)

5. Select **OK** in the success message pop up to finish.



**Welcome to EPDS**

You have successfully updated your information.

[OK](#)

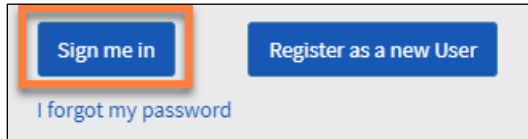
6. If your session remains inactive for 20 minutes, the system will require you to log back in again. You can only be logged in to one session at a time.



## 2.4 On-going Log In

After completing the initial log in steps, the process for subsequent log ins follow steps 2 through 4 in section [2.3](#), as depicted below.

1. Enter your EPDS account email and password. Select **Sign me in**.

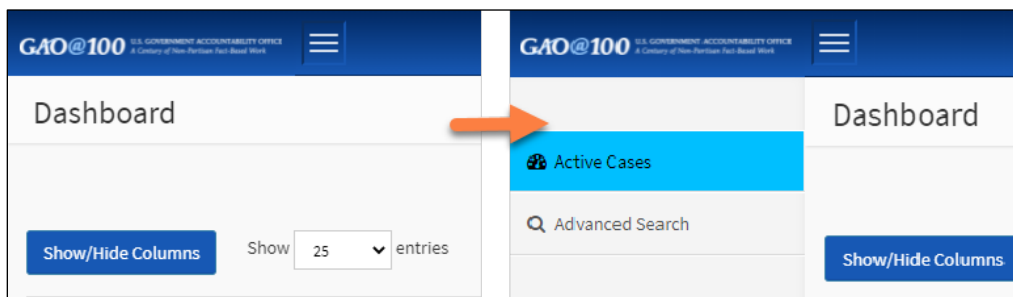


2. If your session remains inactive for 20 minutes, the system will require you to log back in again. You can only be logged in to one session at a time.

### 3.0 Application Introduction

This section provides a high-level description of the EPDS features.

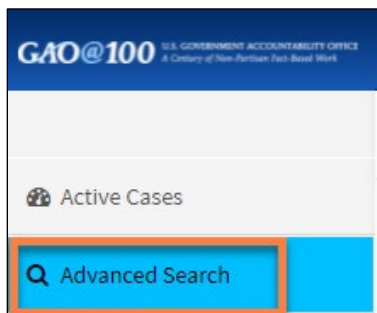
1. Select the menu icon to show or hide the site navigation.



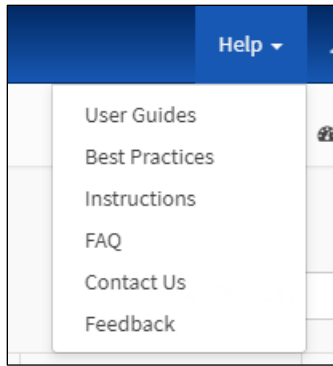
2. In the site navigation, select **Active Cases** to view all assigned protest cases for your group, and to return to your **Dashboard** when you are on another screen. Refer to section [5.1 View an Assigned Case/Case Docket Sheet](#) for more information.



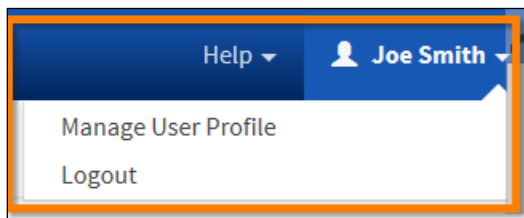
3. Select **Advanced Search** to search protest cases, including open and closed cases. Refer to section [5.7.4 Advanced Search](#) for more information.



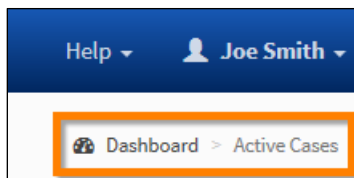
4. Select the **Help** menu (upper right corner) to access **User Guides**, **Best Practices**, **Instructions**, **FAQ**, **Contact Us** and **Feedback** information.



5. Select your name to access the **Manage User Profile** or **Logout** options. Refer to section [8.0 Manage Profile](#) for information on modifying your profile.



6. The breadcrumb navigation displays under the **Help** and user name. This navigation makes it easier to understand where you are on the site.



For instance, this breadcrumb navigation shows that the user is on the dashboard of the site, which displays the user's active cases.

## 4.0 Dashboard

The default view is the dashboard, which shows assigned cases for your group.

**Supervisors** have editing permissions to cases for their group. **Attorneys** have editing permissions **only to cases that have been assigned to them**. Both supervisors and attorneys have **read access** to all cases in EPDS.

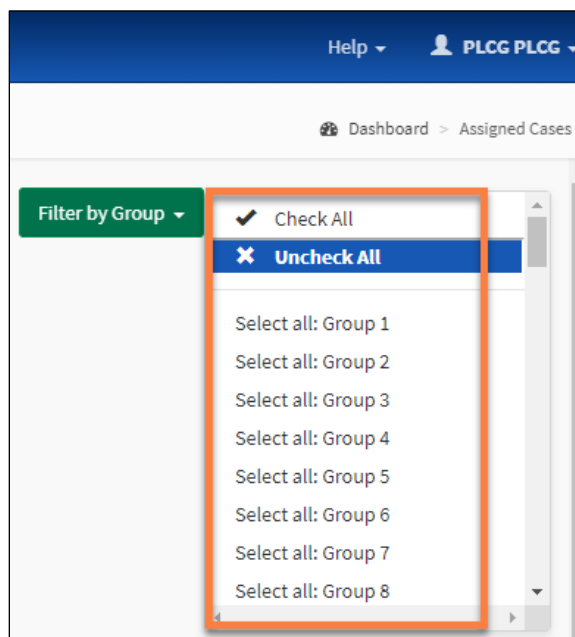
Dashboard Dashboard > Active Cases

[Show/Hide Columns](#) Show 25 entries Filter Records:

| B-Number                                                                                                                              | Protester                | Filing Date              | Agency                                         | Due Date   | EPDS Cntrl #            | Case Type       | Case Status |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------|-------------------------|-----------------|-------------|
| <a href="#">B-417112.1</a><br><a href="#">XYZ vs. B-414342.2</a><br><a href="#">EPDS vs. B-417112.1</a><br><a href="#">B-330578.1</a> | XYZ Corp.                | Jul 24 2018 17:30:00 EDT | Administrative Conference of the United States | 11/01/2018 | <a href="#">A-PS06M</a> | PROTEST         | CLOSED      |
| <a href="#">B-416875.1</a>                                                                                                            | XYZ Test LLC             | Sep 19 2018 09:34:18 EDT | Administrative Conference of the United States | 12/28/2018 | <a href="#">A-BGBPN</a> | PROTEST         | CLOSED      |
| <a href="#">B-417137.2-RECON</a><br><a href="#">ABC vs. B-417135.1</a>                                                                | ABC Test LLC-RECON-RECON | Sep 21 2018 09:05:00 EDT | Administrative Conference of the United States | 03/01/2019 | <a href="#">A-R1CAE</a> | RECONSIDERATION | OPEN        |

### NOTE

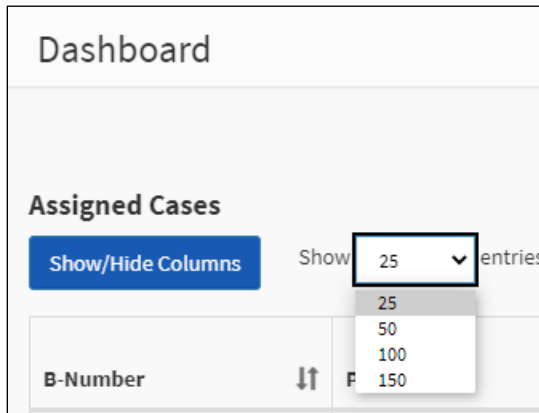
The Filter by Group drop-down button is **only available to supervisors**.



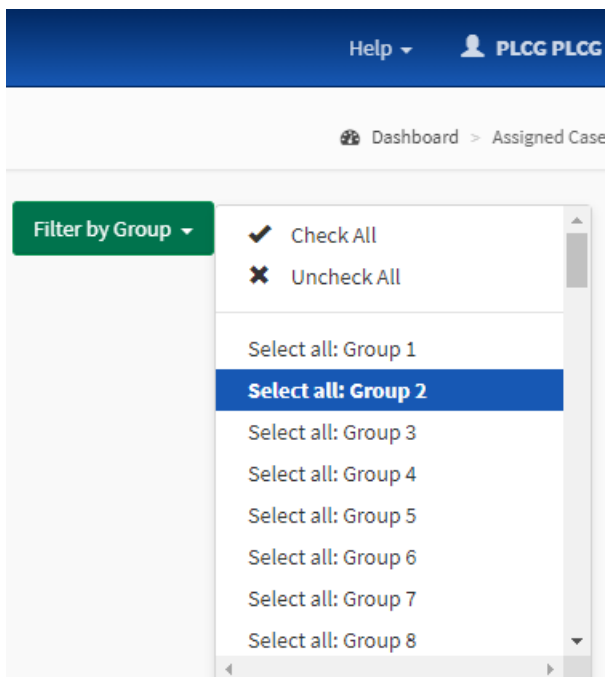
## 4.1 Modify Dashboard

There are several ways to modify the dashboard.

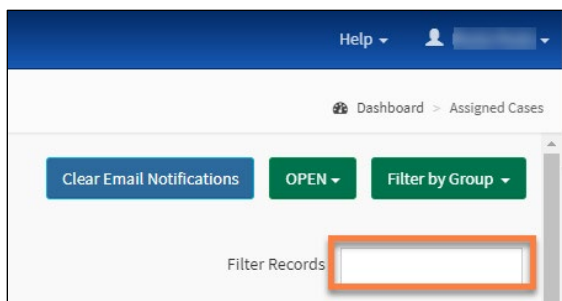
1. **Show More Entries:** select the drop-down entries to change the view to show **25** (default), **50**, **100** or **150** entries (cases).



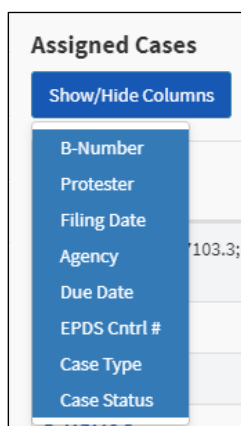
2. **View Active Cases by Group (Supervisors Only):** select the **Filter by Group** button and select or deselect the desired groups.



3. **Filter Entries:** type in a filter parameter in the **Filter Records** field. The records will filter as you type. You can filter by any protest variable (B-Number, agency, due date, etc.). The filter will search all fields for any filter parameter.



4. **Modify Columns:** select the **Show/hide columns** button to select which columns to display.



5. **Sort Columns:** select the column headings to sort entries ascending or descending in that column.

Dashboard Dashboard Unassigned Case

Clear Email Notifications OPEN

Unassigned Cases

Show/Hide Columns Show 25 entries Filter Records:

| Protester                    | Filing Date              | Agency                                         | Due Date   | EPDS Cntrl # | Case Type       | Case Status |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------|-----------------|-------------|
| ABC Test LLC-RECON-RECON     | Sep 21 2018 09:05:00 EDT | Administrative Conference of the United States | 03/01/2019 | A-R1C4E      | RECONSIDERATION | OPEN        |
| EPDS test notify-RECON-RECON | Feb 25 2019 13:26:07 EST | Administrative Conference of the United States | 06/05/2019 | A-QL48B.7    | RECONSIDERATION | OPEN        |
| EPDS test notify-RECON       | Feb 25 2019 13:26:52 EST | Administrative Conference of the United States | 06/05/2019 | A-QL48B.8    | RECONSIDERATION | OPEN        |

## 5.0 Case Information

### 5.1 View an Assigned Case/Case Docket Sheet

To view an assigned case by opening the **Case Docket Sheet**, select the **B-Number** link or on the **EPDS Cntrl #** link.

Dashboard Dashboard > Active Cases

Show/Hide Columns Show 25 entries Filter Records:  OPEN

| B-Number                   | Protester | Filing Date              | Agency                                                           | Due Date   | EPDS Cntrl #              | Case Type | Case Status |
|----------------------------|-----------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|---------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| <a href="#">B-417741.1</a> |           | Sep 30 2019 15:46:05 EDT | Department of Agriculture/Natural Resources Conservation Service | 01/08/2020 | <a href="#">A-FE2L8</a>   | PROTEST   | OPEN        |
| <a href="#">B-417736.1</a> |           | Sep 30 2019 13:29:44 EDT | Administrative Conference of the United States                   | 01/08/2020 | <a href="#">A-W1993.1</a> | PROTEST   | OPEN        |

### 5.2 Case Docket Sheet

The top part of the **Case Docket Sheet** gives the case information. The **Protective Order** field can be edited by selecting **Edit** next to the selection. To save the changes, select the **Save** button that will activate as you edit. Please refer to the following clarification on additional select items in the case information section.

Case Docket Sheet Dashboard > Case Docket Sheet

|                       |                                                |                           |                                                                              |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Case Type             | PROTEST                                        | GAO Attorney Name         | <a href="#">4</a> Brent Burris                                               |
| Company Status        | SMALL                                          | GAO Attorney Email        | epdsgaouser3@gmail.com                                                       |
| Protester             | EPDS TEST GAPI                                 | GAO Attorney Phone Number | (111) 111-1111                                                               |
| B-Number              | <a href="#">1</a> B-899984.4                   | Days Remaining            | <a href="#">5</a> 32                                                         |
| Agency                | Administrative Conference of the United States | Case Status               | <a href="#">6</a> OPEN                                                       |
| Intervenor(s)         | <a href="#">2</a>                              | Protective Order Issued?  | <a href="#">7</a> <input type="radio"/> Y <input checked="" type="radio"/> N |
| Solicitation Number   | unknown                                        |                           |                                                                              |
| Consolidated Protests | <a href="#">3</a>                              |                           |                                                                              |

Download Offline Case Docket Show 100 entries Filter Records:

| Index | Alerts | Type of Filing                    | Filed                                                   | Protected ? | Date                     | Comments | GAO Notes                                                                                               |
|-------|--------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     |        | Protest                           | PROTESTER (EPDS test gap)                               | NO          | Aug 25 2020 18:00:00 EDT |          | t2<br><i>Edited: Sep 10 2020 16:28:19 EDT</i>                                                           |
| 2     |        | Other xxxxx                       | GAO                                                     | NO          | Aug 26 2020 17:01:20 EDT |          |                                                                                                         |
| 3     |        | Notice Of Appearance              | AGENCY (Administrative Conference of the United States) | NO          | Sep 11 2020 13:24:33 EDT |          |                                                                                                         |
| 4     |        | Notice of Appearance Acknowledged | GAO                                                     | NO          | Sep 11 2020 13:26:44 EDT |          | Notice of Appearance for Agency rep Michael<br><i>Transmitted from Administrative Conference of the</i> |

1. **B-Number**: This field shows the number(s) that GAO assigns to the case. All filings in a case should reference the assigned B-Number(s).
2. **Intervenor(s)**: This field shows any intervenors permitted by GAO to participate in the case pursuant to 4 C.F.R. §§ 21.0(b) or 21.3(j).

3. **Consolidated Protests:** If GAO has consolidated the case with another pending case(s), this field shows the title and B-Number(s) of the other case. After cases are consolidated, a filing made in one case will automatically be filed in the joined case(s). Although a user can see and access the documents in all joined cases (subject to the terms of any applicable protective order(s)), **any filings must be made in the filer's own case.**  
For example, GAO has consolidated the protests of Protester A and Protester B. **Protester A**, subject to the terms of any applicable protective order(s), can access and view the docket for **Protester B's** case. However, to file anything in the consolidated cases, **Protester A** must file the document in **Protester A's** case only.
4. **GAO Attorney Name:** This field shows the GAO-assigned attorney for the case.
5. **Days Remaining:** For cases subject to 4 C.F.R. § 21.9, this field shows the number of days remaining for GAO to issue a final decision. For all other cases, this field is inapplicable.
6. **Case Status:** Case status will be **Open** or **Closed**. If a case has been closed for more than 60 days, filers will no longer have access to open or download files from the docket.
7. **Protective Order Issued?:** This field shows whether or not GAO has issued a protective order for the case pursuant to 4 C.F.R. § 21.4. Refer to section [6.3 Protective Order](#) for information on protective orders.



The bottom part of the **Case Docket Sheet** shows the records attached to this protest. Records can include files or docket entries created by GAO.

This section can be sorted by the **Index**, **Filer**, and **Protected** columns. Additionally, you can filter or search the records by using the **Filter Records** field. The **GAO Notes** field can be edited by selecting **Edit** next to the selection. To save the changes, select the **Save** button that will activate as you edit. Any new case docket records are identified with the alert symbol in the **Alerts** column.

### 5.3 Alerts

Any new records on the **Case Docket Sheet** are identified with an alert icon that will display in the **Alerts** column (refer to the following image). The Alert icon will remain visible until the new record is opened.

| Index  | Alerts                                                                             | Type of Filing                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1                                                                                       |   | Reconsideration                               |
| 2                                                                                       |  | In-House Counsel Protective Order Application |

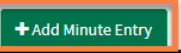
## 5.4 Opening Attachments

Records that contain attachments can be opened by selecting the link in the **Type of Filing** column; the attachments can be viewed and downloaded. (Refer to section [5.7.1 Submit New Documents](#) for instructions on adding attachments). If a protective order has been issued for a case, parties not admitted to the protective order will not be able to access documents containing protected material. Please refer to section [6.3 Protective Order](#) for more information

| Download Offline Case Docket Show 100 entries |                                                                                   |                                   |                                                                     |             |                             |          | Filter Records :                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Index                                         | Alerts                                                                            | Type of Filing                    | Filer                                                               | Protected ? | Date                        | Comments | GAO Notes                                                                                      |
| 1                                             |  | Protest                           | PROTESTER<br>(EPDS test gap)                                        | NO          | Aug 25 2020<br>18:00:00 EDT |          | 12<br><br>Edited: Sep 10 2020 16:28:19 EDT                                                     |
| 2                                             |                                                                                   | Other xxxxx                       | GAO                                                                 | NO          | Aug 26 2020<br>17:01:20 EDT |          |                                                                                                |
| 3                                             |                                                                                   | Notice Of Appearance              | AGENCY<br>(Administrative<br>Conference of<br>the United<br>States) | NO          | Sep 11 2020<br>13:24:33 EDT |          |                                                                                                |
| 4                                             |                                                                                   | Notice of Appearance Acknowledged | GAO                                                                 | NO          | Sep 11 2020<br>13:26:41 EDT |          | Notice of Appearance for Agency rep Michael<br>Testimony from Administrative Conference of the |

## 5.5 Adding a Minute Entry

- To add a record without an attachment, select **Add Minute Entry**.

|                                                                                       |                                                                                     |                |                                                                                     |     |    |                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|----|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3                                                                                     |  | Notice Of Test |  | GAO | NO | Apr 05<br>2019<br>09:44:37<br>EDT |  |  |
| Showing 1 to 3 of 3 entries                                                           |                                                                                     |                |                                                                                     |     |    |                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                       |
|  |                                                                                     |                |                                                                                     |     |    |                                   |                                                                                     |                                                                                       |

- Type notes in the **Add Minute Entry** pop-up, and select **Add**.

 Add Minute Entry
 

Add Minute Entry

250 characters remaining

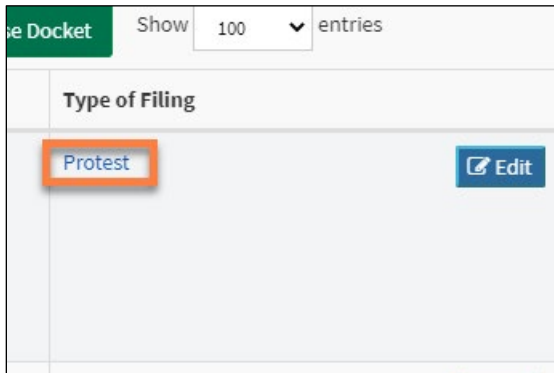
Add

Cancel

## 5.6 Changing a Filing Protected Status

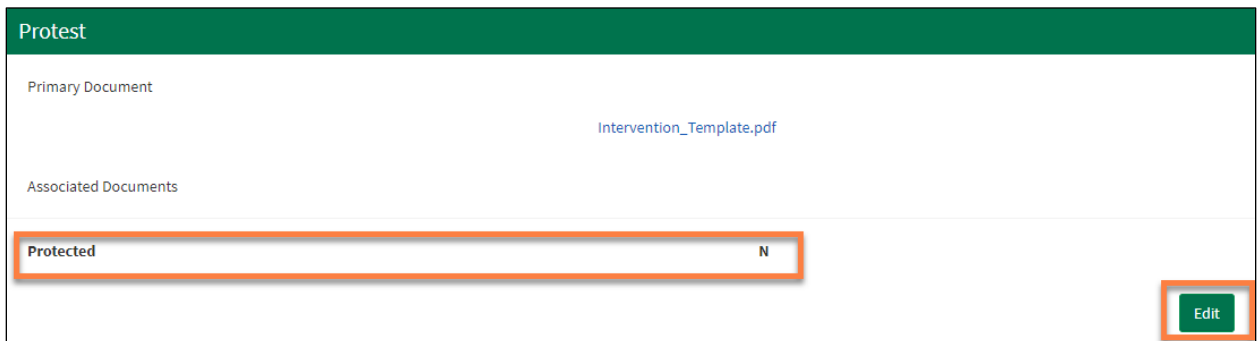
A thorough explanation of protecting filed documents is in section [6.0 Protected Material](#). It is possible for **GAO attorneys and supervisors** to change the **Protected** status of case filings on the case docket page. **You can only change the status for cases that are assigned to you (attorneys) or assigned to your group (supervisors)**

1. First, select the **Type of Filing** link of the desired documents (*not* the **Edit** link).



The screenshot shows the 'Case Docket' header with a 'Show' dropdown set to '100' and 'entries'. Below the header, there is a table with a column titled 'Type of Filing'. The first row in this column contains the word 'Protest', which is highlighted with an orange box. To the right of the 'Protest' link is a blue 'Edit' button with a pencil icon.

2. The next screen will display the current status of the case filings, **Y** or **N**. Select **Edit**.



The screenshot shows the 'Protest' case filing page. It has a green header with the word 'Protest'. Below the header, there is a section for 'Primary Document' with the file name 'Intervention\_Template.pdf'. Underneath, there is a section for 'Associated Documents'. At the bottom of the page, there is a row with a text box labeled 'Protected' containing the letter 'N', and a green 'Edit' button with a pencil icon, both of which are highlighted with orange boxes.

3. Select **Edit** next to the **Protected** selection.

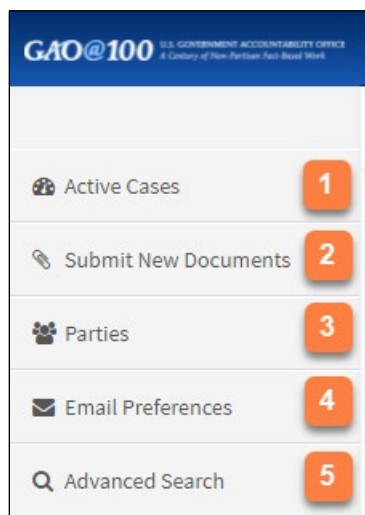


The screenshot shows a row with a text box labeled 'Protected' and a green 'Edit' button with a pencil icon. The 'Edit' button is highlighted with an orange box.

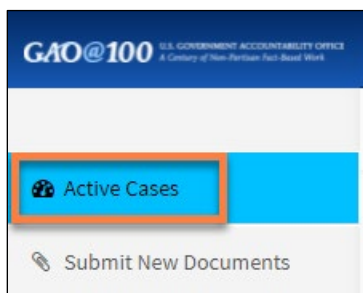
4. Type **N** or **Y** in the text box. Select **Save** to complete. Select **Cancel**, to maintain the current protected status.

## 5.7 Case Docket Sheet Actions

When viewing the **Case Docket Sheet** page, the menu options change from the **Dashboard** view choices. There are five actions that can be taken from the case docket, which are available in the navigation menu on the left side of the page.



1. Return to the dashboard to view **Active Cases**.



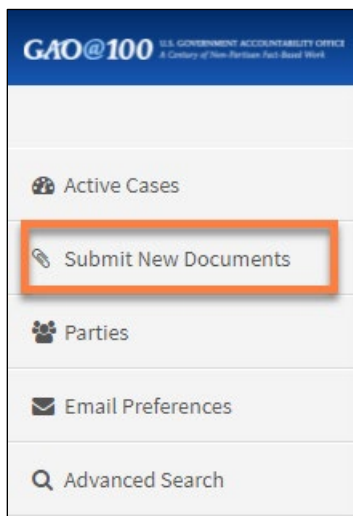
2. **Submit New Documents** for the current case (refer to section [5.7.1 Submit New Documents](#) for more information).
3. View all parties to the case and their respective representatives with access to the case and add primary and secondary representatives in the **Parties** screen (refer to section [5.7.2 Parties](#) for more information).

4. Set your **Email Preferences**.
5. Conduct an **Advanced Search** (refer to section [5.7.4 Advanced Search](#) for more information).

### 5.7.1 **Submit New Documents**

As new documents are submitted, they are automatically attached to the currently viewed case and a new record is entered for that case. Follow the instructions below to submit new documents.

1. In the case docket menu, select **Submit New Documents**.



2. Complete the items on the **Submit New Documents** screen. Additional instructions for completing individual fields follow.

Submit New Document

|                     |                                                |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Protester           | ABC Test Corp.                                 |
| B-Number            | B-417136.1                                     |
| Agency              | Administrative Conference of the United States |
| Solicitation Number | 98716                                          |

Submit New Document

Type of document *(Required)*

Please Select Type of Document

Upload Primary Document (Only PDF, Word & Excel can be attached) *(Required)*

Add File Cancel

| # | Name | Size | Progress |
|---|------|------|----------|
|   |      |      |          |

Do any of these documents contain information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public?  
*(Required)*

☐ Yes ☐ No

Comments - Please provide a description of the document (E.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension, etc.).

250 characters remaining

Submit Reset

3. Select the drop-down arrow to select the **Type of document**. The available options will vary depending on the type of case and the case status (open, closed, complete). The following example displays the **Type of document** menu choices for a 'Protest' case with a 'Closed' status.

Submit New Document

Type of document *(Required)*

Please Select Type of Document

- Please Select Type of Document
- Acknowledgment Package with Protective Order
- Acknowledgment Package without Protective Order
- Notice of Protective Order
- Admission to Protective Order

4. If you select a document type with an underscore (i.e., a blank), a pop-up window will ask you to fill in blank. Type in a brief description of the document, and select **OK**.

Notice Of \_\_\_\_

Please briefly describe the document you are filing (e.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension).

250 characters remaining

OK Cancel

5. Select **Add File** under **Upload Primary Document**.

Upload Primary Document (Only PDF, Word, Excel & Zip files can be attached) (Required)

Add File Cancel

| #                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Name | Size | Progress |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|------|----------|
| <p>Do any of these documents contain information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public? (Required)</p> <p><input type="radio"/> Yes <input type="radio"/> No</p> <p>Comments - Please provide a description of the document (E.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension, etc.).</p> <p>250 characters remaining</p> <p>Submit Reset</p> |      |      |          |

A pop-up menu will appear. Locate the appropriate file on your computer, select it (only **PDF**, **Word**, **Zip** and **Excel** files can be attached), and select **Open**.

6. Once a document is added, you can add additional documents by selecting **Yes** for the question, **Do you want to Upload Associated Documents?**

Do you want to Upload Associated Documents? (Required)

☐ Yes ☐ No

7. If appropriate, select **Yes** for the question **Do any of these documents contain information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public?**

Do any of these documents contain information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public?

☐ Yes ☐ No

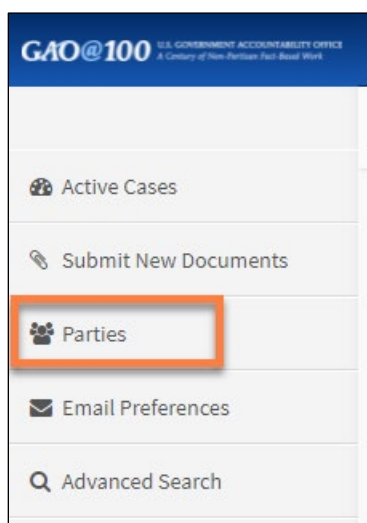
8. Add comments to the **Comments** field if needed. Select **Submit**.

### 5.7.2 Parties

The **Parties** screen displays all the parties associated with the case. **EPDS administrators** can add and delete primary and secondary representatives and agency representatives, and add contacts to protective orders. Each party is allowed to have **up to four representatives** who can access or file documents in EPDS.

**GAO supervisors and attorneys** are able to view all the information posted on the Parties screen. In addition, you can add or remove **Secondary Agency** contacts following these steps:

1. To **add** a representative, on the case docket menu select **Parties**.



2. In the **Parties** screen, you can view the contact information for the protester, the intervenor (if applicable), and the procuring agency representatives. Next, select **Add Secondary Agency**.



| Party                                                                                | Information                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>PROTESTER ( ABC Test Corp. )</b><br>Silver Spring Maryland 20903<br>United States | <b>Primary Representative</b><br>Vendor2 Firm<br>2105 S College Ave<br>Fort Collins Colorado 80528<br>US                                    |
| <b>INTERVENOR ( XYZ Test Inc. )</b>                                                  | <b>Primary Representative</b><br>Vendor2 Firm<br>2325 S College Ave<br>Fort Collins Colorado 80525<br>United States                         |
| <b>Administrative Conference of the United States</b>                                | <b>Agency Representative</b><br>Administrative Conference of the United States<br>56 Nevada<br>Fort Collins Colorado 80526<br>United States |
| <a href="#">+ Add Secondary Agency</a>                                               |                                                                                                                                             |

3. Next, enter the email for the secondary agency representative you would like to add to the case, and select **Select**.

**Select Secondary Agency Representative**

Enter Secondary Agency Attorney email address

**Select**
**Cancel**

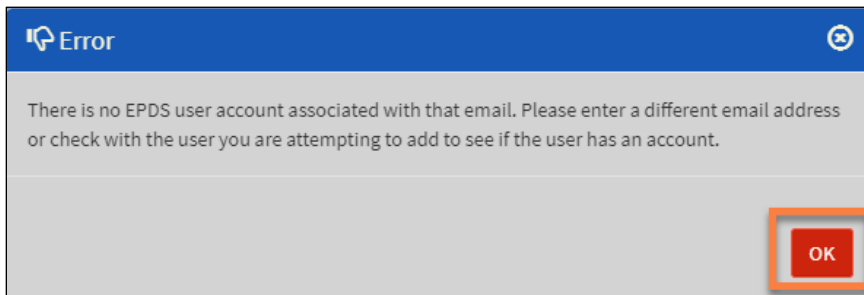
4. A pop-up box will display with the representative's information. Select **Confirm** to continue.

**Attorney Info**

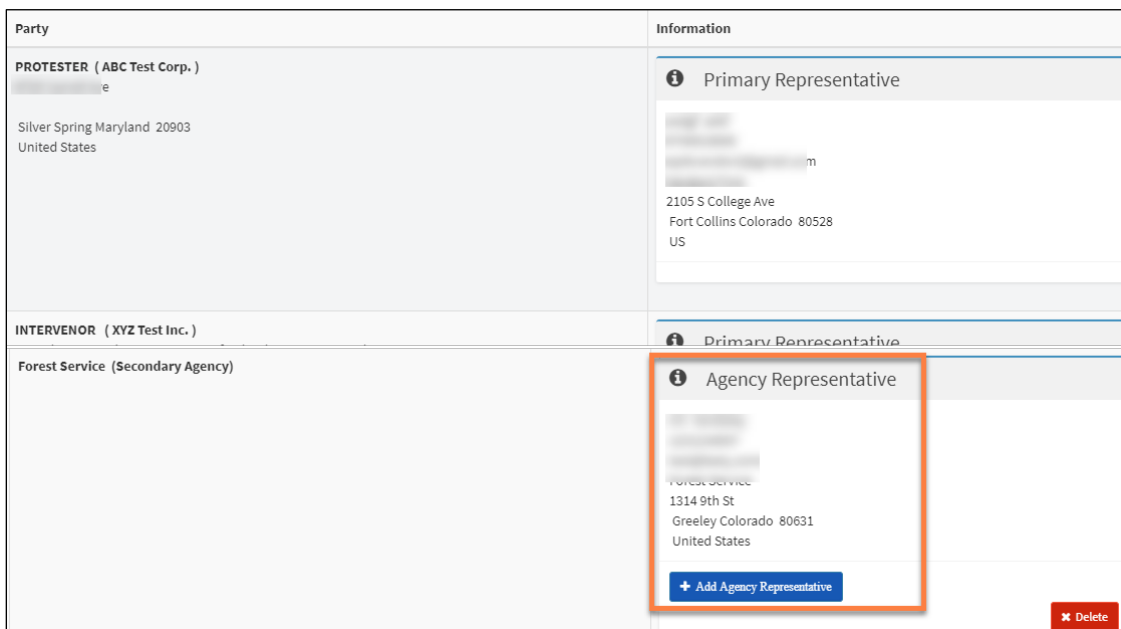
You are adding [redacted] from [redacted]

**Confirm**
**Cancel**

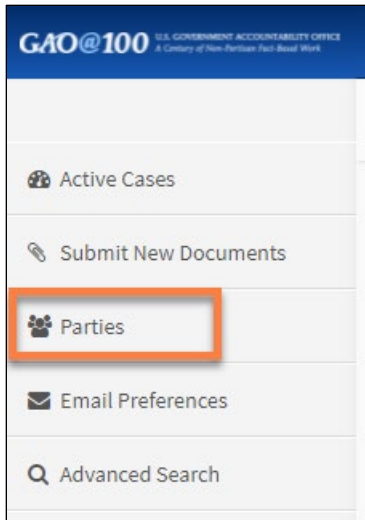
5. If the person whose email you entered does not have an EPDS user account you will receive an error message. Representatives must set up an EPDS account prior to being added to a case.



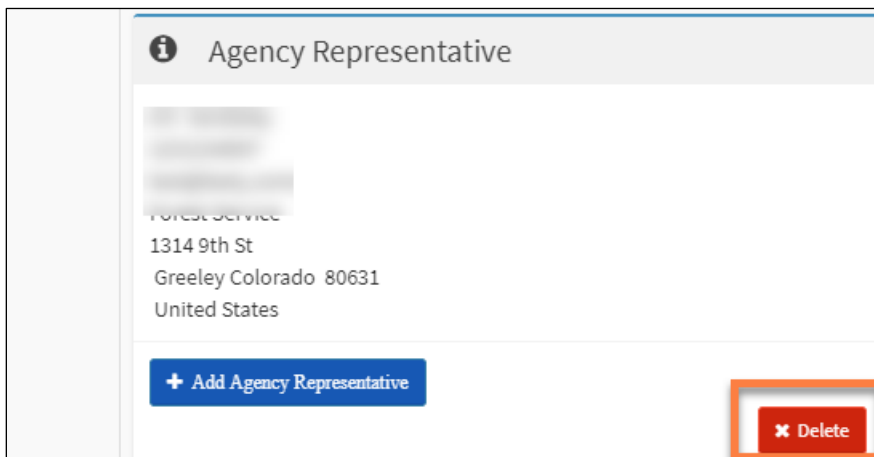
6. The secondary agency representative's contact information will appear on the Parties screen. To add additional agency representatives (**up to four**), repeat the steps.



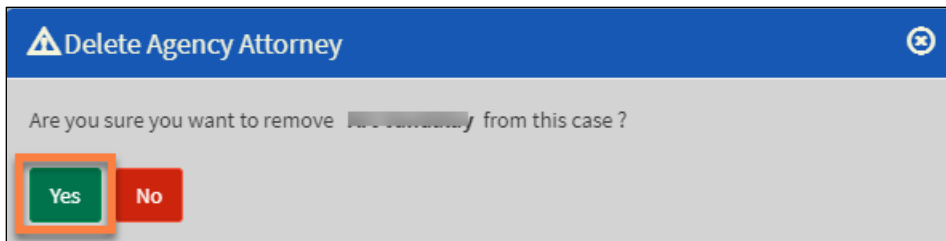
7. To **delete** a representative, on the case docket menu select **Parties**.



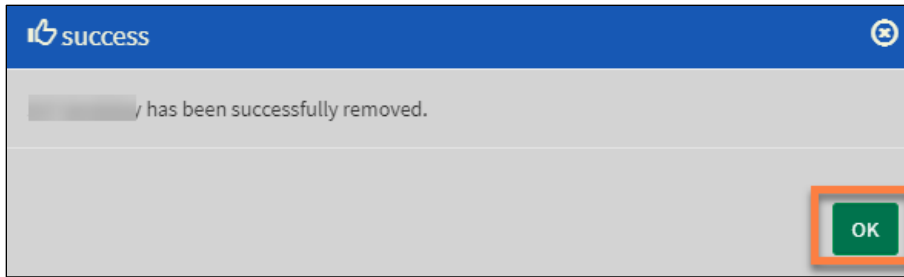
8. In the **Parties** screen, select **Delete** next to the secondary agency representative you wish to remove.



9. A pop-up confirmation message will display. Select **Yes** to continue.



10. A pop-up success message will display. Select **OK** to continue.



The secondary agency representative information is no longer displaying on the Parties screen.

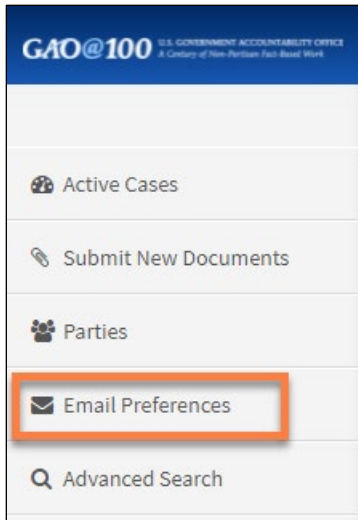
### 5.7.3 *Email Preferences*

All service of filings and notices of case developments will occur by postings to the case docket sheet. When a filing or other case development occurs in EPDS, the default setting is that the system will send all parties an email notification.

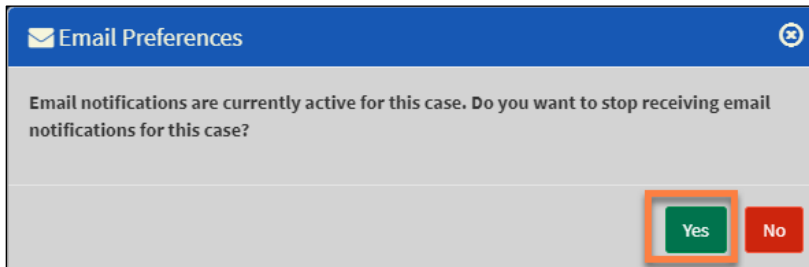


EPDS users are strongly encouraged to keep email notifications activated for each case. Users bear sole responsibility for learning of any new filings or case developments. Follow the instructions below to **deactivate** or **reactivate** email notifications.

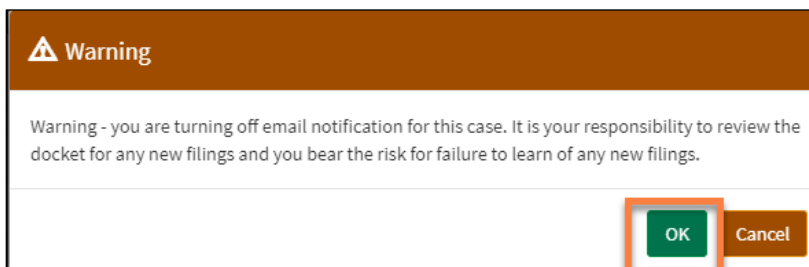
1. To **deactivate** email notifications, in the case docket menu select **Email Preferences**.



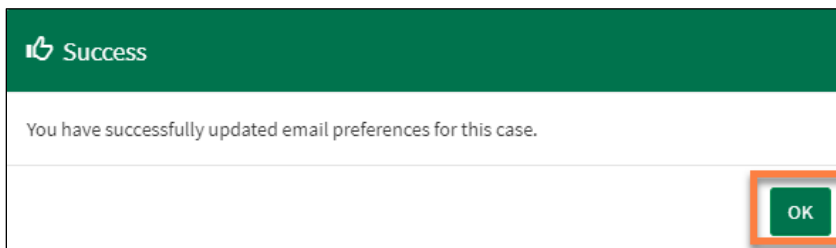
2. Select **Yes** on the **Email Preferences** pop-up box.



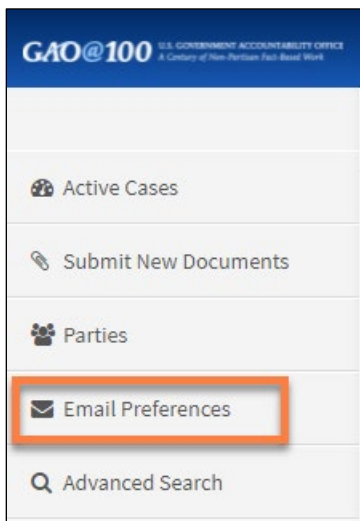
3. Select **Ok** on the **Warning** pop-up.



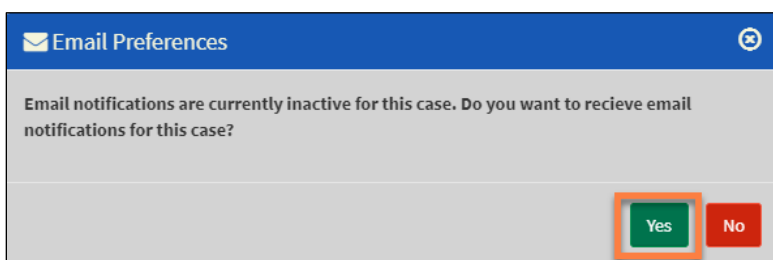
4. Select **OK** on the **Success** pop-up.



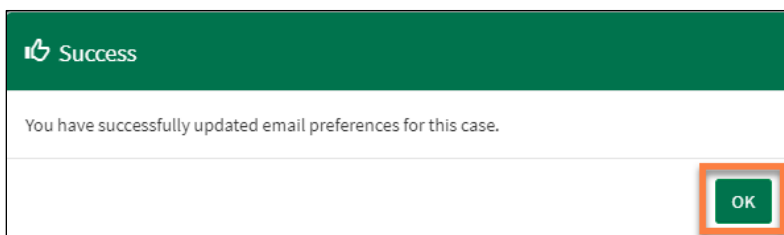
5. To **reactivate** email notifications, on the case docket menu select **Email Preferences**.



6. Select **Yes** on the pop-up box.



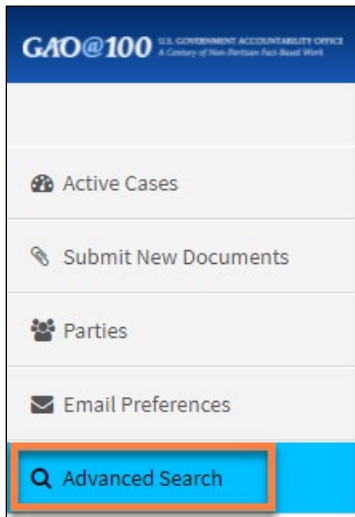
7. Select **OK** on the **Success** pop-up.



## 5.7.4 Advanced Search

Searches can be performed from either the dashboard or from the case docket sheet.

1. To initiate a search from either the **Dashboard** or the **Case Docket Sheet**, select **Advanced Search**.



2. The following image shows the parameters that can be searched. Wildcards can be used for searches. Enter one or more parameters, and select **Search**. To clear all the fields, select **Reset**

A screenshot of the "Advanced Search" form. The form is divided into two main sections: "Filters" on the left and "Filters" on the right. The left "Filters" section includes fields for "File/B#", "EPDS Ctrl #", "Solicitation Number", "Protester", "Date", and "Party Information". The right "Filters" section includes dropdown menus for "Attorney", "Case Status", "Law Group", "Case Type", and "Agency". At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: "Search" and "Reset". The "Search" button is highlighted with an orange rectangular box.

## 6.0 Protected Material

Often protests and associated filings and materials contain a company's proprietary or confidential data or the agency's source-selection-sensitive information that cannot be released publicly, which this guide will collectively refer to as '**protected material**'. The following provides an overview of the EPDS features for properly marking and protecting such material. There is also an explanation of how to prepare redacted versions of documents that can be appropriately released to the public.

### 6.1 Protecting New Cases and Subsequent Filings

In addition to conspicuously marking the document being filed, when filing a new protest (or other case type) and any subsequent filings in a case, EPDS will prompt the filer to answer the question as noted below:

Do any of these documents contain information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public?

☐ Yes

☐ No

The filer should select **Yes** if the filing includes any information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public. When a filer marks a document as containing information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public, only the filing party, GAO, and authorized representatives of the procuring agency will be able to access the filing.

1. As shown in the following example, authorized users can access a protected filing by selecting the title in the **Type of Filing** column. The title is an **active** hyperlink that opens the protected document.



| Case Docket Sheet                                                                          |                                                |                                      |                                                            |             |                             |                           |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|--|
| Case Type                                                                                  | PROTEST                                        |                                      |                                                            |             |                             | GAO Attorney Name         |  |
| Company Status                                                                             | SMALL                                          |                                      |                                                            |             |                             | GAO Attorney Email        |  |
| Protester                                                                                  | ABC TEST CORP.                                 |                                      |                                                            |             |                             | GAO Attorney Phone Number |  |
| B-Number                                                                                   | B-417136.1                                     |                                      |                                                            |             |                             | Days Remaining            |  |
| Agency                                                                                     | Administrative Conference of the United States |                                      |                                                            |             |                             | Case Status               |  |
| Intervenor(s)                                                                              | XYZ TEST INC.                                  |                                      |                                                            |             |                             | Protective Order Issued?  |  |
| Solicitation Number                                                                        | 98716                                          |                                      |                                                            |             |                             |                           |  |
| Consolidated Protests                                                                      |                                                |                                      |                                                            |             |                             |                           |  |
| <a href="#">Download Offline Case Docket</a> Show <input type="text" value="100"/> entries |                                                |                                      |                                                            |             |                             |                           |  |
| Index                                                                                      | Alerts                                         | Type of Filing                       | Filer                                                      | Protected ? | Date                        | Comments                  |  |
| 1                                                                                          |                                                | <a href="#">Protest</a>              | PROTESTER<br>(ABC Test Corp.)                              | YES         | Oct 15 2018<br>14:24:39 EDT | Protest of award to XYZ T |  |
| 2                                                                                          |                                                | <a href="#">Notice Of Appearance</a> | AGENCY<br>(Administrative Conference of the United States) | NO          | Oct 15 2018<br>14:26:25 EDT |                           |  |

2. A user without access (such as an Intervenor), can see that a protected filing has been posted to the Docket. However, the user **can not** open the filing because the title **is not an active hyperlink for them**.

| Index | Alerts | Type of Filing           | Filer                              | Protected ? | Date                        | Comments | GAO Notes |
|-------|--------|--------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------|----------|-----------|
| 1     |        | Protest                  | PROTESTER<br>(Environmental Today) | YES         | Apr 05 2016<br>17:18:55 EDT |          |           |
| 2     |        | Supplemental Protest     | GAO                                | YES         | Apr 06 2016<br>13:53:20 EDT |          |           |
| 3     |        | <a href="#">Comments</a> | PROTESTER<br>(Environmental Today) | YES         | Jul 11 2016<br>15:00:52 EDT |          |           |

## WARNING

Because the docket is always viewable by any party to a case, all parties should refrain from submitting any protected material on the docket, such as in the **Comments** section of the **Submit New Documents** feature. Any **Comments** containing protected material should be set forth in a document that is uploaded to EPDS and appropriately marked with a protected status designation.

As discussed below, if GAO determines that it is appropriate to issue a protective order, counsel who are admitted to the protective order will be able to access documents marked as containing information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public on the docket.

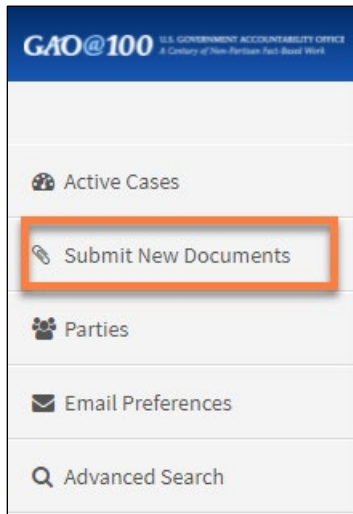
## 6.2 Redacted Versions of GAO Decisions

If GAO issues a protected decision, parties with authorized access to the protected decision can submit proposed redactions. GAO will evaluate the proposed redactions and take one of two actions. The agency may issue a **proposed redacted version** for review by the parties, which indicates that GAO accepts some, but not all of the requested redactions. GAO may also accept the proposed redacted version, and subsequently issue a **final redacted version** that is publically releasable.

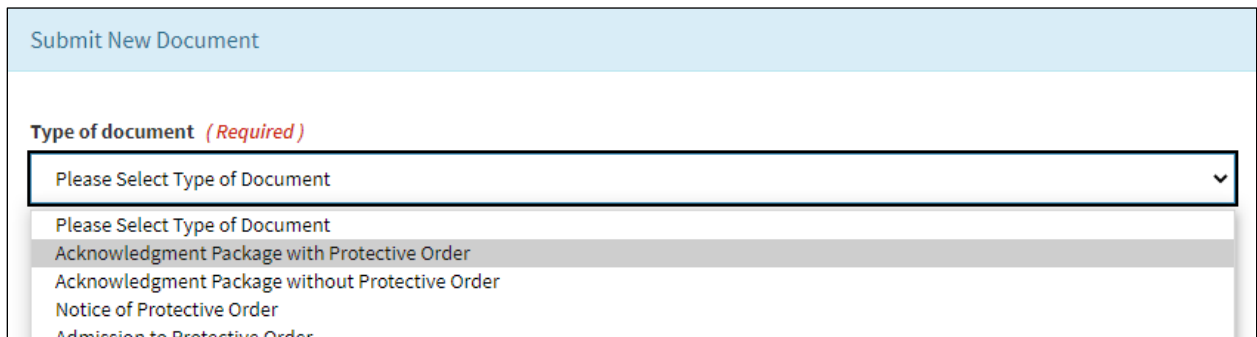
### 6.2.1 *Issuing a Proposed Redacted Version*

In this instance, the GAO has reviewed the parties' proposed redactions, and has decided to accept some, but not all of the requested redactions.

1. Select **Submit New Documents** on the navigation menu.



2. Select **Proposed Public Version** from the **Type of document** dropdown menu.



3. Select **Add File** under **Upload Primary Document**.

Upload Primary Document (Only PDF, Word, Excel & Zip files can be attached) (Required)

**Add File** **Cancel**

| #                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Name | Size | Progress |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|------|----------|
| <p>Comments - Please provide a description of the document (E.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension, etc.).</p> <p>250 characters remaining</p> <p><b>Submit</b> <b>Reset</b></p> |      |      |          |

A pop-up window will appear. Locate the appropriate file on your computer, select it (only **PDF**, **Word** and **Excel files** can be attached), and select **Open**.

- Once a document is added, you can add additional documents by selecting **Yes** for the question, **Do you want to Upload Associated Documents?**
- Add comments to the **Comments** field if needed. Select **Submit**.

## 6.2.2 Issuing a Public Decision

In this instance, the GAO has reviewed the parties' proposed redactions, and has decided to accept the redactions as drafted and issue a **Public Decision**.

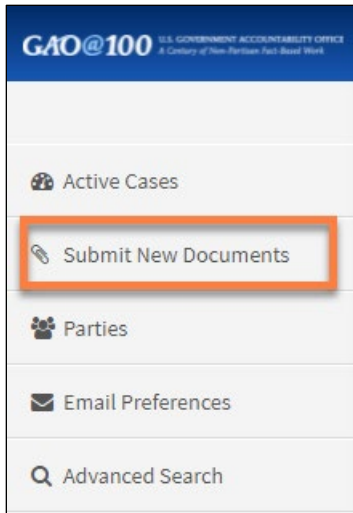
- Open the **Dashboard** and select the protest that has been marked as containing information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public.

Dashboard Dashboard > Active Cases

**Show/Hide Columns** Show 25 entries Filter Records:

| B-Number          | Protester         | Filing Date              | Agency                                                    | Due Date   | PO                                                         | Case Type | Case Status |
|-------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|
| B-417136.1        | ABC Test Corp.    | Oct 15 2018 14:24:39 EDT | Administrative Conference of the United States            | 03/01/2019 | <input type="radio"/> Y <input checked="" type="radio"/> N | PROTEST   | OPEN        |
| B-417119.1        | Amer Testing Comp | Oct 17 2018 16:05:59 EDT | Department of the Air Force/Naval Special Warfare Command | 01/25/2019 | <input type="radio"/> Y <input checked="" type="radio"/> N | PROTEST   | OPEN        |
| B-417118.1        | EPDS Amer Testing | Dec 06 2018 22:47:31 EST | Administrative Conference of the United States            | 03/18/2019 | <input type="radio"/> Y <input checked="" type="radio"/> N | PROTEST   | OPEN        |
| <b>B-417116.1</b> | EPDS Testing      | Jan 24 2019 01:18:36 EST | Department of the Air Force/U.S. Transportation Command   | 05/06/2019 | <input checked="" type="radio"/> Y <input type="radio"/> N | PROTEST   | OPEN        |

- Select **Submit New Documents** on the navigation menu.



3. Select **Public Decision** as the **Type of document**.

Submit New Document

**Type of document** *(Required)*

Public Decision

**Upload Primary Document** (Only PDF, Word & Excel can be attached) *(Required)*

Add File Cancel

| # | Name | Size | Progress |
|---|------|------|----------|
|---|------|------|----------|

**Comments** - Please provide a description of the document (E.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension, etc.).

250 characters remaining

Submit Reset

4. Select **Add File** under **Upload Primary Document**.

Upload Primary Document (Only PDF, Word, Excel & Zip files can be attached) (Required)

**Add File** **Cancel**

| #                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Name | Size | Progress |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|------|----------|
| <p>Comments - Please provide a description of the document (E.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension, etc.).</p> <p>250 characters remaining</p> <p><b>Submit</b> <b>Reset</b></p> |      |      |          |

A pop-up window will appear. Locate the appropriate file on your computer, select it (only **PDF**, **Word**, **Zip** and **Excel files** can be attached), and select **Open**.

- Once a document is added, you can add additional documents by selecting **Yes** for the question, **Do you want to Upload Associated Documents?**
- Add comments to the **Comments** field if needed. Select **Submit**.
- The **Public Decision** is marked as **not** containing information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not releasable to the public and will be accessible by all authorized users with access to the case.

Download Offline Case Docket Show 100 entries Filter Records:

| Index | Alerts | Type of Filing  | Filer                    | Protected ? | Date                     | Comments     | GAO Notes        |
|-------|--------|-----------------|--------------------------|-------------|--------------------------|--------------|------------------|
| 1     |        | Protest         | PROTESTER (EPDS Testing) | NO          | Jan 24 2019 01:16:37 EST | Amer testing | <b>Add Notes</b> |
| 2     |        | Public Decision | GAO                      | NO          | Sep 24 2021 13:29:36 EDT |              | <b>Add Notes</b> |

### 6.3 Protective Order

GAO may, in appropriate cases, issue a protective order that will allow authorized counsel access to all materials in a case that are marked as containing protected material. For additional information regarding GAO's protective order process, please review **Bid Protests at GAO: A Descriptive Guide** and **Guide to GAO Protective Orders** at <https://www.gao.gov/legal/bid-protests/reference-materials>.

- The default setting in EPDS is that a case **will not** have a protective order. As shown on the docket, the following case does not have a protective order.

Case Docket Sheet Dashboard > Case Docket Sheet

|                       |                                                |                           |                                                            |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Case Type             | PROTEST                                        | GAO Attorney Name         | pending                                                    |
| Company Status        | SMALL                                          | GAO Attorney Email        | pending                                                    |
| Protester             |                                                | GAO Attorney Phone Number | pending                                                    |
| B-Number              | B-412739.1                                     | Days Remaining            | 69                                                         |
| Agency                | Administrative Conference of the United States | Case Status               | OPEN                                                       |
| Intervenor(s)         |                                                | Protective Order Issued?  | <input type="radio"/> Y <input checked="" type="radio"/> N |
| Solicitation Number   | unknown                                        |                           |                                                            |
| Consolidated Protests |                                                |                           |                                                            |

- When GAO issues a protective order, the protective order will be available for download on the docket and the protective order issued field on the docket will change to **Y**.

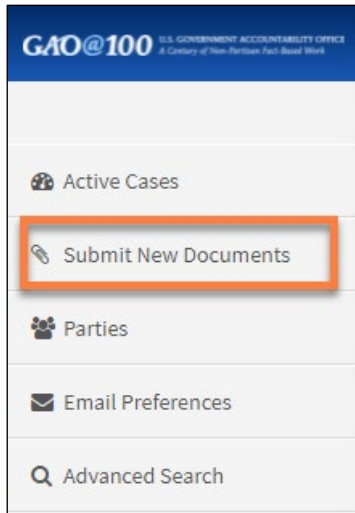
Case Docket Sheet Dashboard > Case Docket Sheet

|                       |                                                |                           |          |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------|
| Case Type             | PROTEST                                        | GAO Attorney Name         |          |
| Company Status        | SMALL                                          | GAO Attorney Email        | @gao.gov |
| Protester             | XYZ TEST, LLC                                  | GAO Attorney Phone Number | 1 (202)  |
| B-Number              | B-412741.1                                     | Days Remaining            | 54       |
| Agency                | Administrative Conference of the United States | Case Status               | CLOSED   |
| Intervenor(s)         |                                                | Protective Order Issued?  | Y        |
| Solicitation Number   | 12312Y                                         |                           |          |
| Consolidated Protests |                                                |                           |          |

### 6.3.1 Admission to a Protective Order

GAO must approve the request to admit a party's representative to a protective order. Once a party's representative(s) has access to the protective order, that representative(s) will have access to all documents on the docket, including documents marked as containing information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not subject to public release. To admit a party's representative to a protective order, follow the steps below.

- First you must create a **Admission to Protective Order** document. While viewing a case on the case docket, select **Submit New Documents**.



2. On the **Submit New Document** screen, select the drop-down arrow for **Type of document** and select **Admission to Protective Order**.

A screenshot of the "Submit New Document" form. The title "Submit New Document" is at the top in a light blue header. Below it, the label "Type of document (Required)" is in red. A dropdown menu is open, showing "Admission to Protective Order" as the selected option, which is highlighted by an orange box. Below the dropdown is a green button labeled "Generate Template". Underneath the button is the word "OR" followed by a horizontal line.

3. There are two methods that can be used to add an **Admission to Protective Order** document. You can select **Generate Template** to create a document using the EPDS template. The other choice is to generate a template in **GTrack**, then sign and scan/save the document to your computer.

#### 6.3.1.1 **Generate Template method:**

- i. Select the **Generate Template** button.

A screenshot of the "Submit New Document" form, similar to the one above. The "Type of document (Required)" dropdown is set to "Admission to Protective Order". The green "Generate Template" button is highlighted with an orange rectangular box. Below the button is the word "OR" followed by a horizontal line.



- ii. Complete any blank fields in the template that do not automatically populate with information, and then select **Save**.

Admission to Protective Order

NOTICE OF ADMISSION TO PROTECTIVE ORDER

The Government Accountability Office has received and reviewed the applications of \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_, attorneys with the firm of \_\_\_\_\_ retained by \_\_\_\_\_ to represent it in this protest.

Based on the information provided by the individuals regarding relationships with the parties to the protest, and in the absence of any objection, the Government Accountability Office concludes that the risk of inadvertent disclosure of protected material is sufficiently minimal to warrant issuance of the protective order. The individuals have represented that they have read the protective order and agree to its terms.

Save Cancel

- iii. The document link will display. If you want to make changes in the admission, select **Edit Template**.

Submit New Document

Type of document *(Required)*

Admission to Protective Order

Edit Template

admissionToProtectiveOrder.pdf

Comments - Please provide a description of the document (E.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension, etc.).

250 characters remaining

Submit Reset

- iv. Add comments to the **Comments** field if needed. Select **Submit**.

### 6.3.1.2 *GCtrack saved file method*

1. Select **Add File** to upload your saved document.

Submit New Document

Type of document *(Required)*

Admission to Protective Order

Generate Template

OR

Upload Template (Only PDF, Word & Excel can be attached) *(Required)*

Add File Cancel

| # | Name | Size | Progress |
|---|------|------|----------|
|---|------|------|----------|

Comments - Please provide a description of the document (E.g., objection to agency's 5 day letter, request for an extension, etc.).

250 characters remaining

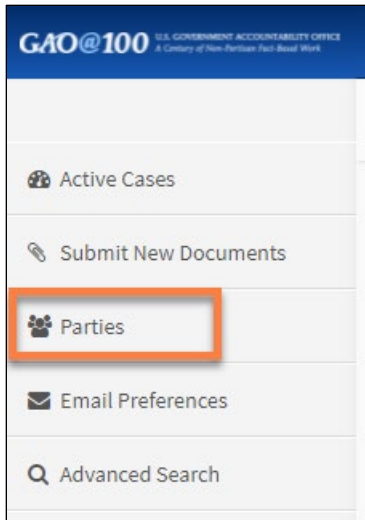
Submit Reset

A pop-up window will appear. Locate the appropriate file on your computer, select it (only **PDF**, **Word**, **Zip** and **Excel** files can be attached), and select **Open**.

2. Once a document is added, you can add additional documents by selecting **Yes** for the question, **Do you want to Upload Associated Documents?**
3. Add comments to the **Comments** field if needed. Select **Submit**.
4. The **Admission to Protective Order** will appear on the case docket.

| Index | Alerts | Type of Filing                | Filer                    | Protected? | Date                     | Comments     | GAO Notes                 |
|-------|--------|-------------------------------|--------------------------|------------|--------------------------|--------------|---------------------------|
| 1     | !      | Protest                       | PROTESTER (EPDS Testing) | NO         | Jan 24 2019 01:16:37 EST | Amer testing | <a href="#">Add Notes</a> |
| 2     |        | Public Decision               | GAO                      | NO         | Sep 24 2021 13:29:36 EDT |              | <a href="#">Add Notes</a> |
| 3     |        | Admission to Protective Order | GAO                      | NO         | Sep 24 2021 13:42:41 EDT |              | <a href="#">Add Notes</a> |

5. Next, you must admit representatives to the **Protective Order**. Begin by selecting **Parties** on the Case Docket sheet menu.



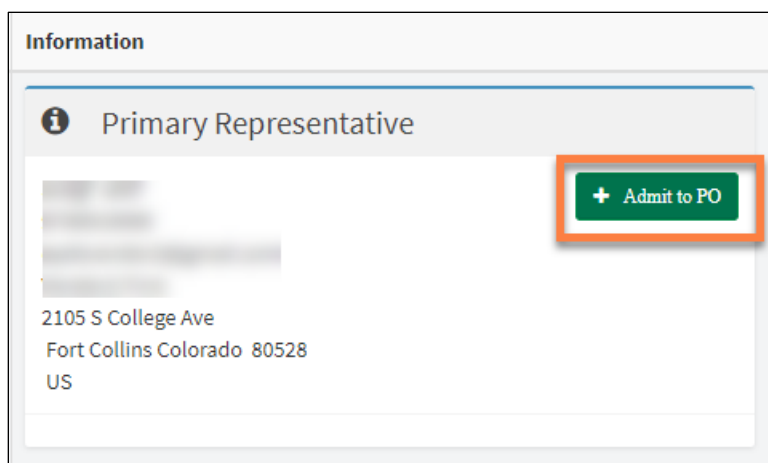
6. Representatives for the protesting and intervenor (if applicable) parties will have an **Admit to PO/Remove from PO** toggle button next to their contact information. In the following example, the primary representative has not yet been admitted to the PO.

| Parties             |                                                         | GAO Attorney Information  |                                                                         |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Protester           | EPDS Testing                                            | GAO Attorney Name         | Brent Burris                                                            |
| B-Number            | 9-417116.1                                              | GAO Attorney Email        | epdsgaouser3@gmail.com                                                  |
| Agency              | Department of the Air Force/U.S. Transportation Command | GAO Attorney Phone Number | (111) 111-1111                                                          |
| Solicitation Number | s-45678                                                 | GAO Attorney Address      | 441 G St., NW<br>District of Columbia Washington 20548<br>United States |

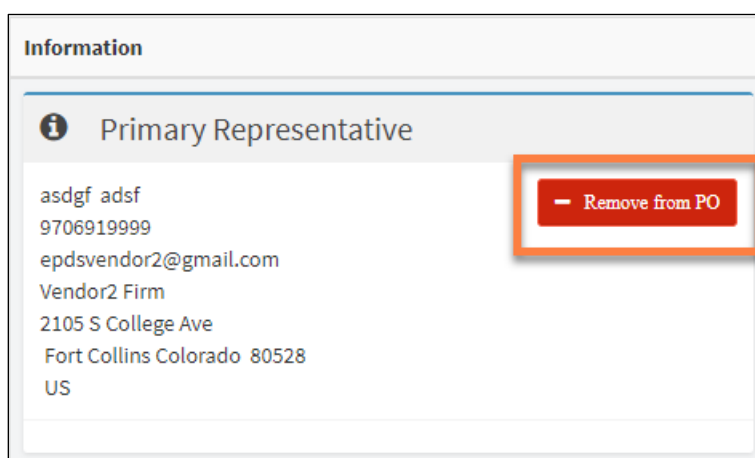
| Party                                                                                             | Information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>PROTESTER ( EPDS Testing )</b><br>5629 Johnson Dr<br><br>Mission Kansas 66202<br>United States | <b>Primary Representative</b><br><br>asdfg adsf<br>9706919999<br>epdsvendor2@gmail.com<br>Vendor2 Firm<br>2105 S College Ave<br>Fort Collins Colorado 80528<br>US <div style="text-align: right;"> <input type="button" value="+ Admit to PO"/> </div> |

7. Select **Admit to PO** to admit the selected representative to the PO.



The screenshot shows a web interface with a header 'Information'. Below it is a section titled 'Primary Representative' with an information icon. The main content area contains a blurred profile picture and the address: '2105 S College Ave', 'Fort Collins Colorado 80528', and 'US'. A green button with a plus sign and the text 'Admit to PO' is highlighted with an orange border.

8. The button toggles to display **Remove from PO**, indicating the representative has been successfully admitted to the PO.



The screenshot shows the same web interface as the previous one, but the button is now red with a minus sign and the text 'Remove from PO', and it is highlighted with an orange border. The address information remains the same.

**i NOTE**

EPDS only allows **up to four representatives for a party with the ability to upload or download filings**. Additional representatives, however, may be admitted to the protective order and subsequently have access to protected material.

### 6.3.2 *Revocation of Access to a Protective Order*

GAO may, in appropriate circumstances, revoke a party's access to the protective order. In such cases, the user will no longer have access to documents marked as containing information that is proprietary, confidential, or otherwise not subject to public release. To remove a party's representative from a protective order, follow the steps below.



5. The button toggles to display **Admit to PO**, indicating that the representative has been successfully removed from the PO. This means that they can no longer view any **'protected material'** associated with this case.

Information

**i** Primary Representative

[Blurred Profile Picture]

2105 S College Ave  
Fort Collins Colorado 80528  
US

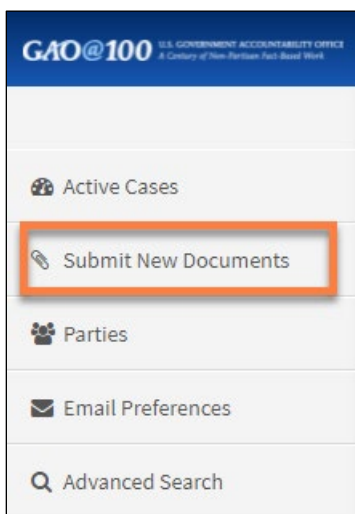
**+ Admit to PO**

## 4. Closing/Completing Cases

GAO staff with the PLCG user role can change a case status to **Closed**. When a case has been closed for more than 60 days, staff should change the status to **Complete**. After the case moves to completed status, filers will no longer have access to open or download documents from the case docket. GAO attorneys may also have a role in closing and completing cases, therefore the following instructions demonstrate that process.

### a. Closing Cases

1. Open the case docket sheet (refer to section [5.1 View an Assigned Case/Case Docket Sheet](#) for additional information) and select **Submit New Documents** to upload a public decision document.



2. Select the drop-down arrow for **Type of document**, and select the type of decision (i.e., Protected or Public). The following example depicts filing a **Public Decision**.

Submit New Document

Type of document *(Required)*

Please Select Type of Document

- Please Select Type of Document
- Acknowledgment Package with Protective Order
- Acknowledgment Package without Protective Order
- Notice of Protective Order
- Admission to Protective Order
- Amended Admission to Protective Order
- Public Notice Of \_\_\_\_
- Notice Of \_\_\_\_
- Protected Decision
- Public Decision**
- Withdrawal Confirmation
- Hearing Confirmation

3. Select **Add File**. A pop-up menu will appear. Locate the appropriate file on your computer, select it (only **PDF** and **Excel files** can be attached), and select **Open**.

Submit New Document

Type of document *(Required)*

Public Decision

Upload Primary Document (Only PDF, Word & Excel can be attached) *(Required)*

**Add File** Cancel

| # | Name | Size | Progress |
|---|------|------|----------|
|---|------|------|----------|

4. Once a document is added, you can add additional documents by selecting **Yes** for the question, **Do you want to Upload Associated Documents?**
5. Add comments to the **Comments** field if needed. Select **Submit**.
6. The system will return you to the **Case Docket Sheet**. The **Case Status** field is automatically updated to **Closed**.

Case Docket Sheet

|                       |                                                         |                           |                        |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------|
| Case Type             | PROTEST                                                 | GAO Attorney Name         |                        |
| Company Status        | LARGE                                                   | GAO Attorney Email        |                        |
| Protester             | EPDS TESTING                                            | GAO Attorney Phone Number |                        |
| B-Number              | 8-417116.1                                              | Days Remaining            | 100                    |
| Agency                | Department of the Air Force/U.S. Transportation Command | Case Status               | <b>CLOSED</b>          |
| Intervenor(s)         |                                                         | Protective Order Issued?  | Y <a href="#">Edit</a> |
| Solicitation Number   | 5-45678                                                 |                           |                        |
| Consolidated Protests |                                                         |                           |                        |



7. Parties who have not disabled notifications will be notified by email of the decision.

When a case is closed, protesters, intervenors, and agencies can view and download documents from the case for **60 days**.

### a. Completing Cases

After 60 days, EPDS changes the case status to **Public Decision +60 days** and documents can no longer be accessed. **This change in status is only visible to PLCG and GAO users.**

Case Docket Sheet

|                       |                                                                     |                           |                                               |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Case Type             | PROTEST <a href="#">Edit</a>                                        | GAO Attorney Name         | Brent Burris <a href="#">Assign Attorney</a>  |
| Company Status        | SMALL <a href="#">Edit</a>                                          | GAO Attorney Email        | epdsgaouser3@gmail.com                        |
| Protester             | EPDS TEST ZIP <a href="#">Edit</a>                                  | GAO Attorney Phone Number | (111) 111-1111                                |
| B-Number              | B-899971.1 <a href="#">Edit</a>                                     | Days Remaining            | 93                                            |
| Agency                | Administrative Conference of the United States <a href="#">Edit</a> | Case Status               | PUBLIC DECISION +60 DAYS <a href="#">Edit</a> |
| Intervenor(s)         |                                                                     | Protective Order Issued?  | N <a href="#">Edit</a>                        |
| Solicitation Number   | unknown <a href="#">Edit</a>                                        |                           |                                               |
| Consolidated Protests |                                                                     |                           |                                               |

### i. Mark as Complete

To complete cases that have been closed for more than 60 days, follow the instructions below:

1. Run an advanced search for cases with the status **Public Decision +60 Days**. Refer to section [5.7.4 Advanced Search](#) for information on running advanced searches.

Advanced Search

|                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>Filters</p> <p>File/B#</p> <p>EPDS Ctrl #</p> <p>Solicitation Number</p> <p>Protester</p>                    | <p>Filters</p> <p>Attorney</p> <p>Case Status</p> <p>Law Group</p> <p>Case Type</p>                                                              |
| <p><input type="text"/></p> <p><input type="text"/></p> <p><input type="text"/></p> <p><input type="text"/></p> | <p><input type="text"/></p> <p><input type="text" value="PUBLIC DECISION +60 DAYS"/></p> <p><input type="text"/></p> <p><input type="text"/></p> |

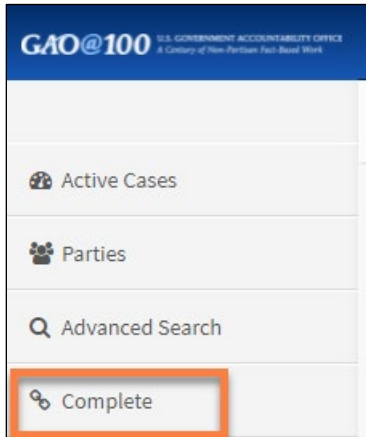
2. On each case that is returned, select the **B-Number** link.

Search Results

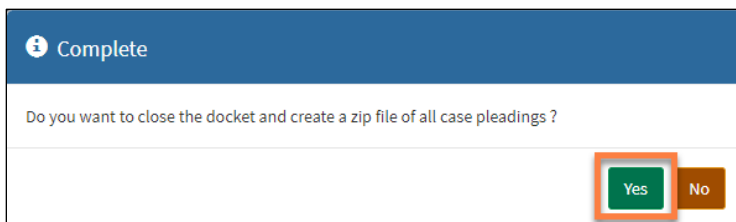
[Export To Excel](#) Show 10 entries Filter Records:

| B-Number   | Protester | Filing Date              | Agency                                         | Solicitation Number | Due Date   | Group # | Attorney Name | Case Type | Case Status                 |
|------------|-----------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------------|---------|---------------|-----------|-----------------------------|
| B-416443.6 |           | Oct 29 2018 17:12:39 EDT | Department of Education                        | 91003118R0024       | 02/06/2019 | Group 2 |               | PROTEST   | PUBLIC DECISION<br>+60 DAYS |
| B-899992.1 |           | Apr 03 2020 12:43:12 EDT | Administrative Conference of the United States | unknown             | 07/13/2020 | Group   |               | PROTEST   | PUBLIC DECISION<br>+60 DAYS |

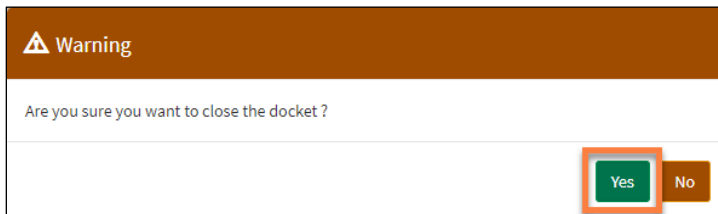
3. In the case docket navigation menu, select **Complete**. The following example shows the Attorney navigation menu.



4. Select **Yes** on the **Complete** pop-up box.



5. Select **Yes** on the **Warning** box.



6. The system will create a final record entry as a **zip file** titled **GAO Closeout File for B-(blank)**. Protesters, intervenors, and agencies **cannot see** this zip file. Select the zip file link.

| Download Offline Case Docket |        | Show 100 entries                 | Filter Records: |             |                             |          |                           |
|------------------------------|--------|----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------|-----------------------------|----------|---------------------------|
| Index                        | Alerts | Type of Filing                   | Filer           | Protected ? | Date                        | Comments | GAO Notes                 |
| 7                            |        | GAO Closeout File for B-416635.1 | GAO             | NO          | Sep 01 2021<br>19:14:18 EDT |          | <a href="#">Add Notes</a> |

- On the **Document View** page, select the zip file link.

Document View

Case Information

Protester: Protection Strategies, Inc.

B-Number: B-416635.1

Agency: Department of Energy/Department of Energy

Solicitation Number: DE-SOL-0010747

Document Information

Docket#

Document Type

Filer

Submission Date

Comments

GAO Notes

GAO Closeout File for

Primary Document

B-416635.1.zip

Associated Documents

Edit

- In the **Save As** dialogue box, navigate to where you want to save the zip file on the docket management system, and select **Save**.

### ***1. Case Completion Workflow***

- Upload the file to **GC Track**, and note the **Docket Management Number (DM#)**. Refer to the **GC Track** documentation for instructions.
- In the navigation menu, select **Case Docket Sheet**.



- In the navigation menu, select **Final Record**.



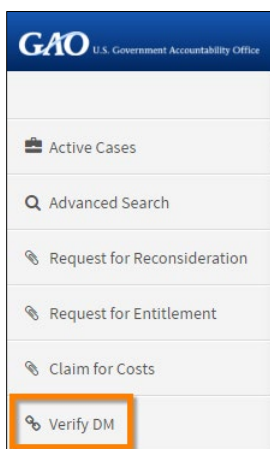
4. Enter the DM# noted in step 9 in the **Enter DM #** pop-up, and select **OK**. **The case needs to be reviewed and verified as the last step in closing the case.**

 A screenshot of the 'Enter DM #' pop-up form. The form has a blue header with the text 'Enter DM #'. Below the header is a text input field labeled 'DM#', which is highlighted with an orange rectangular box. Below the input field is a note: '\*Please enter the Docket Management Number(DM#). Input above will accept only numbers.' At the bottom right of the form are two buttons: 'OK' (green) and 'Cancel' (orange). The 'OK' button is highlighted with an orange rectangular box.

## b. Verifying Cases

Any GAO user can verify and complete a case, **except for the user who originally created the zip file in the previous section**. Follow the instructions below to verify and finalize closing out a case.

1. In the case docket sheet, select **Verify DM**.



2. Enter the **DM#** as in the documentation management system, and select **OK**.

- If the **DM#** does not match, select **OK** on the **Error** pop-up box, and try again.

If the **DM#** still does not match, notify the user who finalized the case that there may be data entry error. Refer to section [7.4 Updating the DM#](#) for steps to resolve this issue.

- If the **DM#** matched, the screen will refresh, and the **Case Status** will change to **COMPLETE**.

The screenshot shows the 'Case Docket Sheet' form. The 'Case Status' field is highlighted with an orange box and contains the text 'COMPLETE' with an 'Edit' button next to it. Other fields include Case Type (PROTEST), Company Status (SMALL), Protester (EPDS TEST JOIN1), B-Number (B-899997.1), Agency (Administrative Conference of the United States), Intervenor(s) (empty), Solicitation Number (unknown), and Consolidated Protests (empty). The right side of the form includes GAO Attorney Name (Brent Burris), GAO Attorney Email (epdsgaouser3@gmail.com), GAO Attorney Phone Number ((111) 111-1111), Days Remaining (100), and Protective Order Issued? (N).

- On the 11th day after a case is marked **Complete**, EPDS will automatically delete the zip file.

#### a. Updating the DM#

Follow the instructions below to update the **DM#** if there was data entry error.

- In the **Case Docket Sheet**, select **Edit** for the **DM#** field.

The screenshot shows the 'Case Docket Sheet' form. The 'DM#' field is highlighted with an orange box and contains the text '6541234' with an 'Edit' button next to it. Other fields include Case Type (PROTEST), Company Status (SMALL), Protester (EPDS TEST 1), B-Number (B-899980.1), Agency (Administrative Conference of the United States), Intervenor(s) (empty), Solicitation Number (unknown), and Consolidated Protests (empty). The right side of the form includes GAO Attorney Name (Brent Burris), GAO Attorney Email (epdsgaouser3@gmail.com), GAO Attorney Phone Number ((111) 111-1111), Days Remaining (100), Case Status (READY TO COMPLETE), and Protective Order Issued? (N).

- Update the **DM#** and select **Save**.

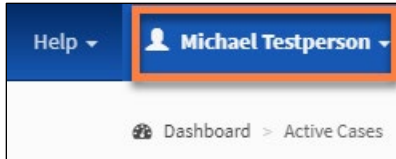
|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| GAO Attorney Name         | Brent Burris                                                                                                                         |
| GAO Attorney Email        | epdsgaouser3@gmail.com                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| GAO Attorney Phone Number | (111) 111-1111                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Days Remaining            | 100                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Case Status               | READY TO COMPLETE                                                                                                                    |
| Protective Order Issued?  | N                                                                                                                                     |
| DM#                       | <div><input type="text" value="6541233"/>  </div> |

3. Notify the approver that the **DM#** has been updated.

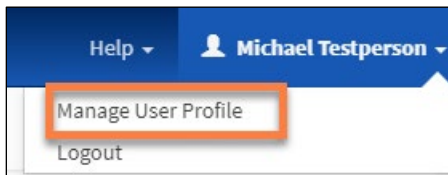
## 2. Manage Profile

Follow these instructions to update your profile. You can edit most information except for your email address.

1. Select your name in the upper right corner of the window.



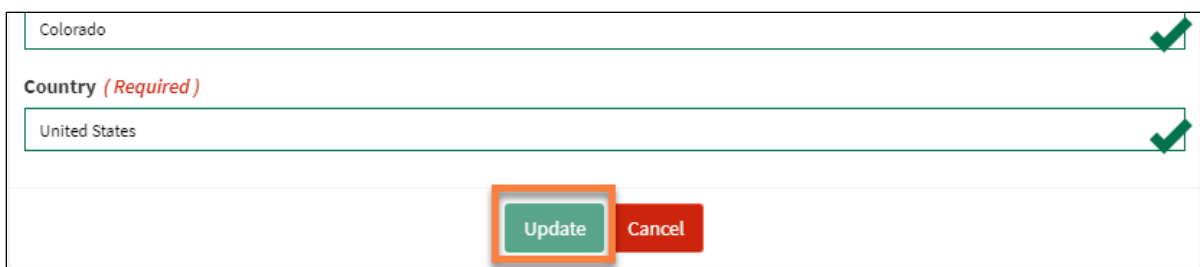
2. Select **Manage User Profile**.



3. Select **Edit**.

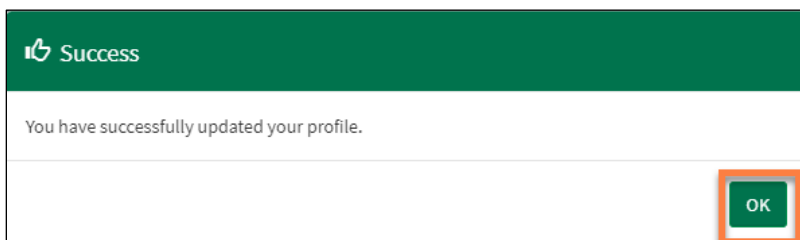
A screenshot of the 'Profile' edit form. The form has a title bar 'Profile' with an 'Edit' button in the top right corner, which is highlighted with an orange rectangle. The form contains several input fields: 'Prefix' (empty), 'First Name (Required)' (containing 'Michael' with a green checkmark), 'Middle Initial' (empty), 'Last Name (Required)' (containing 'Testperson' with a green checkmark).

4. Update your information.
5. Select **Update**.



A form with two input fields. The first field contains 'Colorado' and has a green checkmark at the end. The second field is labeled 'Country (Required)' and contains 'United States', also with a green checkmark at the end. Below the fields are two buttons: 'Update' (highlighted with an orange box) and 'Cancel'.

6. Select **OK** on the **Success** pop-up window.



A success pop-up window with a green header bar containing a checkmark icon and the word 'Success'. Below the header, the text reads 'You have successfully updated your profile.' At the bottom right, there is a button labeled 'OK' (highlighted with an orange box).

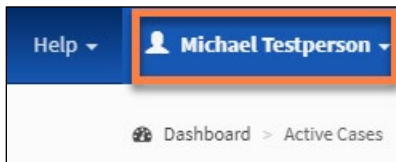


## 2. Manage Password

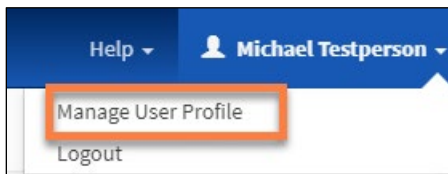
### a. Change Password

Follow these instructions to change your password.

1. Select your name in the upper right corner of the window.



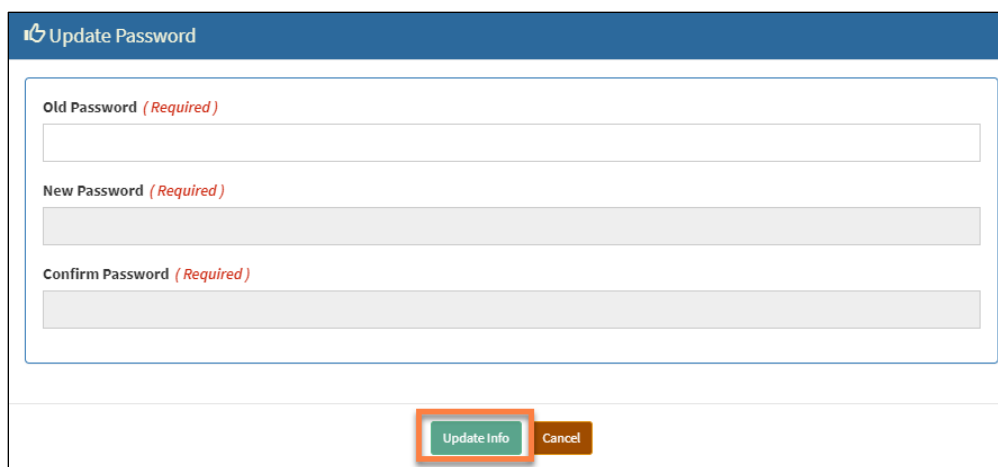
2. Select **Manage User Profile**.



3. Select **Change Password** on the navigation menu.

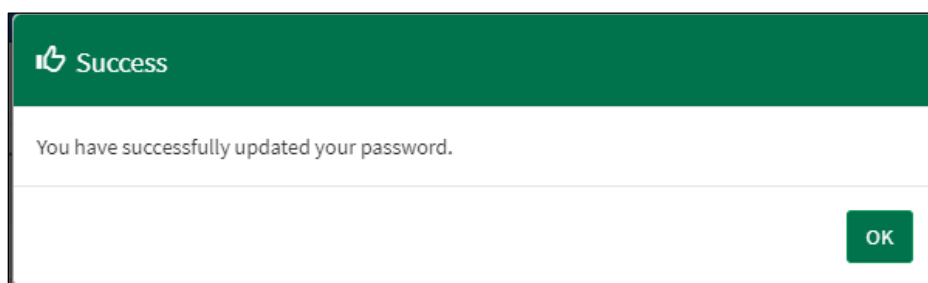


4. Enter your current password, then your new password. Confirm your password in the next field, and select **Update Info**.



The image shows a web form titled "Update Password" with a blue header bar. Inside the form, there are three text input fields, each with a label and a "(Required)" note in red: "Old Password (Required)", "New Password (Required)", and "Confirm Password (Required)". The "New Password" and "Confirm Password" fields are currently disabled (grayed out). At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: "Update Info" (highlighted with a red rectangle) and "Cancel".

5. Select **OK** on the **Success** pop-up window.

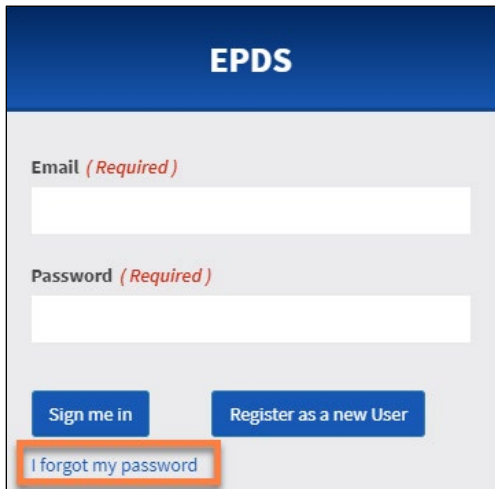


The image shows a "Success" pop-up window with a green header bar. The main content area is white and contains the text "You have successfully updated your password." In the bottom right corner, there is a green button labeled "OK".

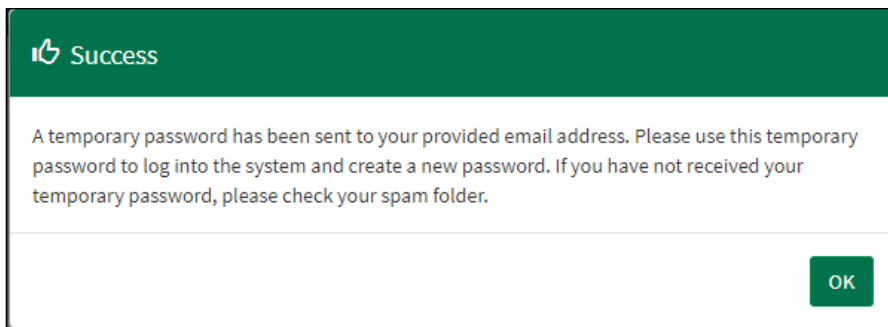
## b. Reset Password

If you forget your password, you can reset your password using the following instructions:

1. On the EPDS login page, select the **I forgot my password** link.

The image shows the EPDS login page. At the top is a blue header with the text "EPDS". Below the header is a light gray form area. It contains two input fields: "Email (Required)" and "Password (Required)". Below the password field are two blue buttons: "Sign me in" and "Register as a new User". At the bottom of the form area, there is a link that says "I forgot my password", which is highlighted with an orange rectangular border.

2. In the pop up, enter the email address associated with your EPDS account, and select **OK**.
3. Select OK on the Success pop-up window.

The image shows a "Success" pop-up window. It has a green header bar with a white checkmark icon and the word "Success". Below the header is a white area with green text that reads: "A temporary password has been sent to your provided email address. Please use this temporary password to log into the system and create a new password. If you have not received your temporary password, please check your spam folder." At the bottom right of the white area is a green button with the text "OK".

4. You will receive an email with a temporary password and instructions for resetting your password. Copy the temporary password, and select the link in the email to update your password.

**THIS E-MAIL CONTAINS IMPORTANT INFORMATION PERTAINING TO YOUR ABILITY TO ACCESS THE ELECTRONIC PROTEST DOCKET SYSTEM - DO NOT LOSE THIS MESSAGE!**

Your account has been reset. Please use the following temporary password to access your account :

**I:ioeL\*Q:9;8**

Tips on copying and pasting the system-generated temporary password: Due to the cryptic nature of the system-generated password, it may be easier for you to copy and paste the password from this e-mail into the password field on the EPDS login page. To copy and paste the password from this e-mail:

1. highlight the temporary password with your mouse **(be sure to include ONLY the characters in the password and NOT the blank spaces that precede or follow the password);**
2. with the password highlighted, press both the Ctrl key and letter 'C' to copy the password;
3. position your cursor in the password field in the EPDS login screen and press both the Ctrl key and letter 'V' to paste the password into the password field.

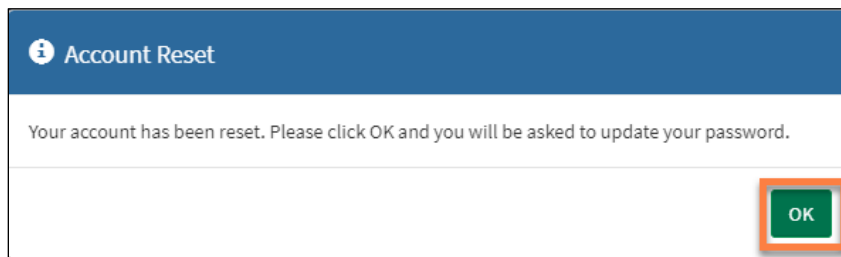
Note: these instructions work for PC users only

Log into the **ELECTRONIC PROTEST DOCKET SYSTEM (EPDS)** and reset your password as prompted.

Your password must include at least 12, but no more than 24 alphanumeric and special characters with no spaces, including at least:

- 12-24 characters
- One number (0 to 9)
- One uppercase letter
- One lowercase letter
- One special character ! # \$ - % + = : ; ? ~ \*
- Dictionary words may not be used in passwords
- The previous 10 passwords may not be re-used

5. Follow the login steps as in section [2.3 Initial Log In](#), using the temporary password that you copied in step [4 above](#).
6. Select OK on the **Account Reset** pop-up window.

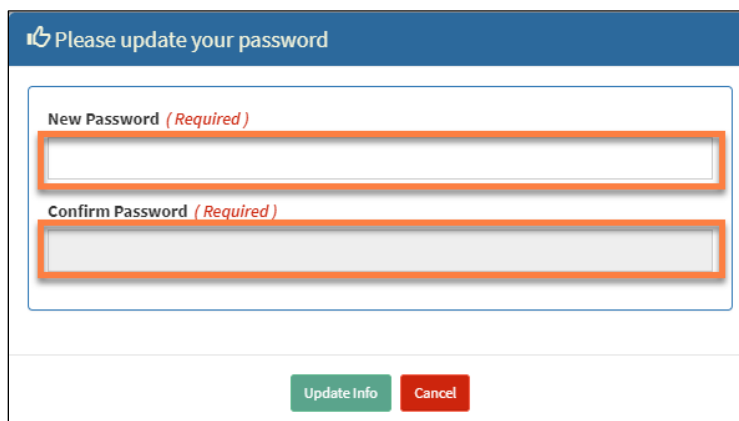


**Account Reset**

Your account has been reset. Please click OK and you will be asked to update your password.

**OK**

7. Enter your new password. Confirm your new password in the next field, and select **Update Info**.



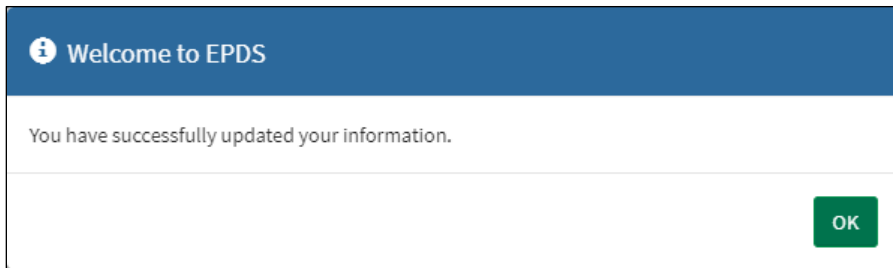
**Please update your password**

New Password (Required)

Confirm Password (Required)

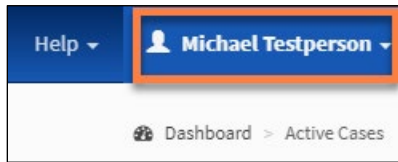
**Update Info** **Cancel**

8. Select **OK** on the **Welcome to EPDS** success pop-up window.

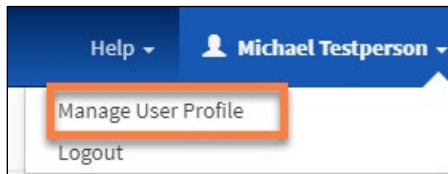


## 2. Change Security Questions

1. Select your name displayed in the upper right corner of the window.



2. Select **Manage User Profile**.



3. Select **Change Security Questions** on the navigation menu.



4. Select and complete three distinct security questions. If you only want to change one or two items, you can re-enter some of the questions you used previously. Select **Update Info** to finish.

 **Change Security Questions**

**Warning!**  
Please select and answer three distinct questions from the selections below. This information will be used to validate your identity if you forget your password. Each question may only be used once. For additional assistance, select the Help ? above.

**Security Question 1 ( Required )**

What was your childhood nickname? ▼

**Security Question 2 ( Required )**

In what city did you meet your spouse/significant other? ▼

**Security Question 3 ( Required )**

What is your oldest sibling's middle name? ▼

Update Info

Cancel

### **3. System Unavailability**

GAO will endeavor to maintain the availability of EPDS during normal business hours, which are Monday through Friday, 8:00 a.m. to 5:30 p.m. Eastern Time, excluding federal holidays or when GAO's headquarters are otherwise closed. In the event that a filer is unable to file a document in EPDS due to a technical failure of EPDS during normal business hours, please refer to the EPDS instructions available at: <http://gao.gov/legal/>. If a filer is unable to file a document in EPDS during a period other than normal business hours, the filer should attempt to file its document during the next period of normal business hours.



## List of Acronyms

| Acronym          | Definition                            |
|------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>EPDS</b>      | Electronic Protest Docketing System   |
| <b>GAO</b>       | U.S. Government Accountability Office |
| <b>Sys Admin</b> | System Administrator                  |